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TAMIL NADU



Neglected and uncared-for: Sterilisation of community dogs is outsourced to contractors at the ABC centres in local bodies. These centres lack facilities to take good care of the dogs. The photo shows the Coimbatore Corporation's ABC centre at Ondipudur. M. PERIASAMY

Failing at ABC

The abject failure of the Animal Birth Control programme in the State is apparent on the streets. Here, **P.V. Srividya** does a deep dive to reveal that the ABC programme, besides being in a shambles, is inhumane, corrupt, and cruel, in many cases.

An internal dossier of the Oulgaret Municipality in Puducherry documented an event in late 2025. Fifty emaciated dogs were released from an Animal Birth Control (ABC) centre there. The animals had been starved for a month and 20 dog deaths were recorded. There were also 50 complaints against the veterinarian. The ABC centre was run by the Hyderabad-based Vet Society for Animal Welfare and Rural Development. “Just before the inspection, the animals were released hastily,” says G. Ashok Raj, activist and honorary member of the Animal Welfare Board of India (AWBI). “The animals came out skin and bones; many had sutures falling apart. Community dog feeders saw some dogs dropping dead. We suspect they were starved for days,” he said.

In July, the Supreme Court dismissed petitions seeking prevention of animal cruelty at ABC centres in local bodies where sterilisation of community dogs is outsourced to contractors. It also upheld its earlier order allowing organisations that do not have Project Recognition Certificates (PRCs) from the AWBI to perform sterilisation.

On July 23, community dogs were found alive with loose sutures and no post-operative care at an ABC shelter in Velankanni in Nagapattinam district. Activist V. Dhanasekaran said dog carcasses were found in the garbage, and they had bloody sutures and wires and ropes (banned in the dog-catching process under the ABC Rules) around their necks. The District Animal Welfare Officer’s report said 70 dogs – 64 males and six females – had been sterilised in three days by two veterinarians with the Chennai-based Pet Care Foundation. The organisation was blacklisted, the town panchayat executive officer told *The Hindu*.

An in-depth investigation by *The Hindu* across the State reveals this is not merely a case of a few NGOs taking advantage of the system.

Quick-fix surgeries

Local bodies handle ABC by outsourcing the process. The allocation is ₹1,650 per dog, including ₹450 for sterilisation and vaccination and ₹200 for catching and release. Effectively, local bodies incentivise projected numbers in ABC, not actual outcomes, activists say, adding that this has reduced the ABC process into an assembly-line work on a massive scale. Dog-catchers, since they are paid per catch, reportedly try to boost numbers and pick up “unfit” dogs too – pups, lactating dogs, sterilised dogs, and pregnant ones.

On September 2, a female dog was found with its intestines spilling out, fighting for life, at Manargudi in Tiruvarur district, after being sterilised at the ABC centre there. “If it was not found on time, the dog would have died,” says a veterinarian.

“Evisceration happens when skin and muscle open up and abdominal organs come out, primarily because the surgical sutures have fallen apart. This is mostly seen in females,” explains a senior surgeon trained by Worldwide Veterinary Services.

“Evisceration and hernia are surgical complications arising from improper suturing techniques, entirely the surgeon’s fault. In suturing, we call it a bite; the distance between two bites should be less than half-a-centimetre. This process naturally takes more time. ABC centres do not follow this; instead they push young veteri-

I agree there may be a nexus between some local bodies and NGOs. But I have written to the Municipal Administration Department to withhold bills and constitute panels to implement the ABC programme properly

P. CHOKKALINGAM,
Member, State Monitoring Committee for the ABC programme

narians to do more surgeries. Skin sutures may open in case the animal is hyperactive,” the surgeon says.

Pain management is also given short shrift at these centres. A multi-modal analgesic can provide relief to the animal after surgery. However, many ABC centres skip this to cut cost, the surgeon further says. In pain, the dog licks the sutures, thus opening them up. Surgical site infections are also caused by reuse of leftover suture material, the surgeon points out.

Speed is again a criterion in male sterilisations. “There are two kinds: on-scrotal and pre-scrotal. The on-scrotal technique leaves gaps between sutures for fluid drain, and therefore is not recommended for shelter dogs (or owner dogs, for that matter) because it increases the chances of catching infections from unhygienic floors,” says another veterinarian trained by the Worldwide Veterinary Services, who worked with an NGO at an ABC centre. He says he had to quit because the NGO had insisted that he perform more on-scrotal procedures.

Mandates under ABC Rules

The ABC Rules, 2023, mandate humane capture of community dogs with nets; feeder outreach before capture; geotagging of capture and release at same location; CCTVs in the operation theatre; pre- and post-operative care; clean and spacious kennels; food twice a day; and water at all times. They call for establishing organ inspection committees to count the number of organs

for billing claims and also advises the immediate destruction of the organs through deep burial or incineration.

On April 20, 2026, Vatsala of Tiruppur noticed a six-year-old community dog missing. He had been neutered four years ago, his ear notched as a mark of sterilisation. Vatsala suspected the hand of Pranimitran, the NGO hired by the Tiruppur Corporation for its ABC project, and went to the centre to check. “At the centre, I saw the dog lying on the floor seemingly lifeless. I thought he was dead. I confronted the founder at the centre and asked him why they had taken a sterilised dog. He claimed that the dog needed vaccination, but he had no explanation for the dog having been anaesthetised for a vaccine shot.” An FIR was later filed against the NGO over the death of two pups in Tiruppur.

Pranimitran’s contract had been terminated by the Hosur Corporation following complaints of animal mutilation, botched surgeries, and non-disclosure. The NGO was blacklisted by the AWBI for the same reasons, said an official of the Board. However, the Tiruppur Corporation brought the NGO on board. A Tiruppur Corporation official says, “There are many complaints against Pranimitran, but we haven’t found a contractor to replace it.”

Only six organisations have the recognition for carrying out ABC procedures in the State, but there are about 15 ‘NGO-contractors’ operating in this space now. “Even the AWBI is aware of this. The gap between ABC and birth rate should be met,” says P. Chokkalingam, Member, State Monitoring Committee for the ABC programme and Chief Executive Officer, Tamil Nadu Animal Welfare Board (TNAWB).

Two other blacklisted NGOs – Jeeva Karunyam of Nagercoil and Rajeshwari Goshala of Tirunelveli – continue to work for the respective local bodies. At Avadi in Chennai, two FIRs were filed against International Peace Trust.

TNAWB-run centres in semi-rural areas are worse, says the Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (SPCA) coordinator and anti-cruelty officer, V. Balakrishnan. At T. Nalligoundenpalayam in Pollachi, the post-operative care unit is 2 km away from the surgery centre. “Last week, a female dog died of evisceration after surgery by a veterinarian of the Animal Husbandry Department,” he claims.

To understand the math, *The Hindu* calculated the cost of care of a dog (see graphic) for an ABC centre. Factoring in economies of scale, an ABC centre can make a profit of ₹66,000 even while adhering to ethical standards of care.

NGO did not provide us with fresh batches of vaccines either. This is the case at most ABC centres, the honourable exceptions being centres such as Besant Memorial Animal Dispensary (BMAD) in Chennai,” adds the doctor.

In response to a question from *The Hindu*, Pranimitran points the finger elsewhere: “The cold chain is provided by the Corporation and is inspected by them, and if the vaccines are ineffective, there would be a rabies outbreak.” At Oulgaret in Puducherry, the fridge was in disrepair for some time when the ABC was functioning last year, says Mr. Ashok Raj, the activist.

There is also extensive relocation of community dogs that are picked up for sterilisation, in violation of the ABC Rules, according to community feeders. They point out that a healthy dog returned to the same locality is also a real-time audit of the community’s money spent.

Fudging numbers

At Oulgaret, a bucket of organs stored at the ABC centre was quietly transported to Neyveli township in nearby Cuddalore district to provide organs for an organ counting committee inspection in 2025, says an eyewitness. “The double counting was done by the same veterinarian who was also doing ABC surgeries at Neyveli. A petition was given to the Collector then complaining about this practice.”

“Numbers are cooked up because targets are unreasonable. When NGOs botch up, they wash their hands off the case and vanish,” alleges a Corporation official, fixing the blame on the NGOs. Bills are cleared on the basis of NGOs’ claims, photos of surgery, photos of dogs, and occasional organ counts by municipal sanitation officers, *The Hindu’s* investigation reveals. Now, the Corporations have withheld payment for bills raised over the last three months.

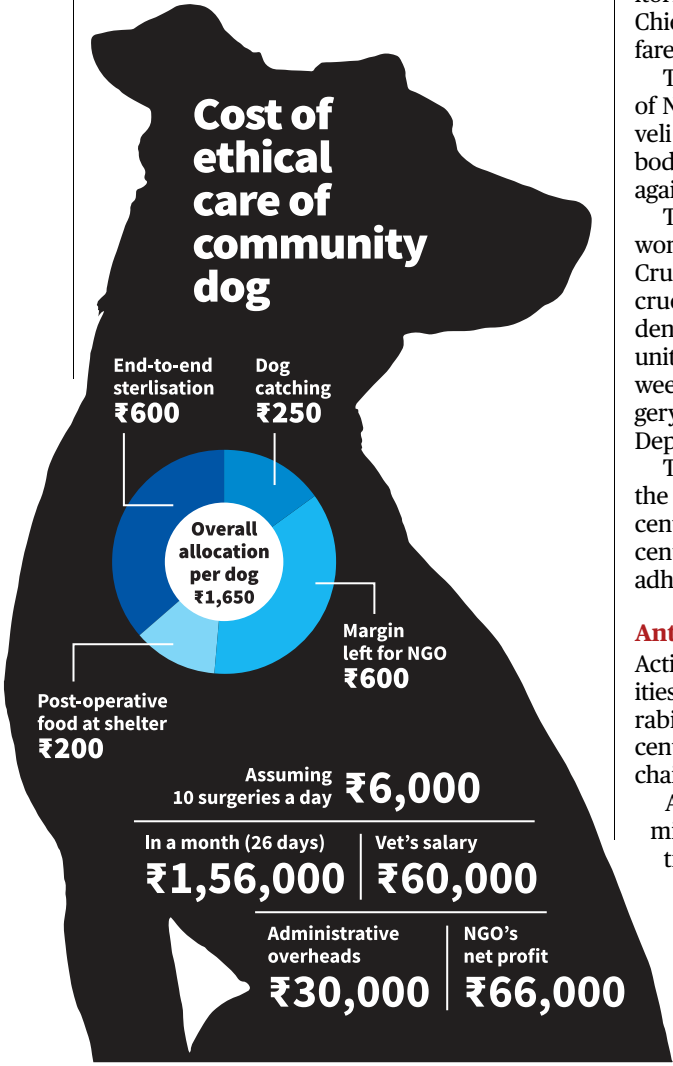
In Tiruppur, with over 9,000 surgeries done, the committee has just been formed, says an official. “I agree there may be a nexus between some local bodies and NGOs. But I have written to the Municipal Administration Department to withhold bills and constitute committees to implement the ABC programme properly,” says Dr. Chokkalingam.

The Hindu’s questions to the Director of Municipal Administration, as to whether time-tagged photos, videos of organ count, and destruction of organs were being audited for every batch of sterilisation bills, were unanswered. There was no response to questions about ABC targets too.

Activists have recommended that community animals be brought under an animal management framework under the Animal Husbandry Department and not be put through an arbitrary system with little control or supervision.

While community feeders, who want an efficient and accountable ABC programme, are leading the protests in this area, it makes good financial and civic sense for the government to institute a systemic overhaul of its current ABC strategy. As the country struggles to handle its community dogs in a humane manner and is under assault for failed ABC and vaccination programmes, a transparent and animal-centric birth control and anti-rabies vaccine programme is the need of the hour.

(With inputs from Ancy Donal Madonna in Tiruchirappalli; P. Sudhakar in Tirunelveli; Sibi Sreevathson T.C. in Coimbatore; and S.P. Saravanan in Erode)



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From Page One

DVAC searches 30 places linked to K.N. Nehru

The DVAC officials seized 241 incriminating documents, besides electronic evidence, allegedly linked to irregularities in the tender process.

In Tiruchi, searches were conducted at the residences of the Corporation's former Chief Engineer Sivapatham at Shanmuga Nagar and Mr. Nehru's former Personal Assistant Manikandan in Srirangam.

Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi, Tiruchi Mayor M. Anbazhagan and several DMK members were present during the search at Mr. Nehru's residence at Thillai Nagar in Tiruchi.

‘Act of revenge’

After the seven-hour-long search concluded at 3 p.m., Mr. Nehru told reporters outside his residence that he had extended full cooperation to the DVAC team during the search, which, he said, was surely an act of political vendetta by the TVK government. He further said DMK president M.K. Stalin had spoken to him and asked him to extend cooperation for the search.

Mr. Stalin alleged that the DVAC was conducting the searches for political reasons. In a social media message, he said the searches were being conducted when a case was pending before the High Court and the Assembly was in session.

He said the people of Tamil Nadu knew about the “horse trading” by the ruling party, and that an FIR in connection with the issue was pending.

“The government is conducting the raids to divert people’s attention, when Indian democracy is heading towards a dark period. The DMK and Mr. Nehru will not be cowed down by these acts. We will challenge them legally,” he said.

Dismissing the allegations of political retaliation, Minister for Energy Resources and Law C.T.R. Nirmalkumar said the DVAC searches at the residences of senior political figures were entirely procedure-driven, and that no individual possessed the authority to interfere in anti-corruption investigations. “There is absolutely no political vendetta behind this. No one has the right to interfere in the functioning of the DVAC.”

In Coimbatore, the DVAC conducted searches at the residences of Mr. Nehru's brothers Manivanan at Kallimadaai and Ravichandran at Masakalipalayam. The residence of the Corporation's retired Town Planning Officer, Sasi Priya, at Sivaram Nagar in Ramanathapuram was also searched.

2 sites shortlisted for Chennai’s new airport

Sources said the Cheyyur site was about 40 km from the Puducherry airport and nearly 35 km from Kalpakkam. It is also nearly 100 km from the existing airport at Meenambakkam. The Manelore site was about 50 km from the city and 35 km from Sriharikota. Sources said that even if AAI recommends one of the two sites, there could be some difficulty in getting the remaining approvals from various regulatory bodies, given the location of both sites. “There is some possibility for Cheyyur, provided the Ministry of Defence gives clearance since the airspace in the region is controlled by the Indian Air Force, Tambaram. But Manelore has some challenges,” a source said.

As the next step, a team of AAI officials will visit both sites and carry out an inspection, after which the report will be drafted. The report is expected to be submitted in a few months. “The State government wants to start the process on the second airport soon. It will help if the AAI speeds up and gives the report at the earliest,” another source said. But another source pointed out that even if the State government wanted to build the second airport soon, it must be prepared to wait for a minimum of five to seven years to make this project a reality.

Efforts on to capture second tiger in Gudalur

The Hindu Bureau
UDHAGAMANDALAM

The Forest Department confirmed on Saturday that it had expanded operations to capture a second tiger in the Gudalur Forest Division.

A statement said: “In order to capture the tiger sighted in Nambalakottai and Vimalagiri areas of the Gudalur Forest Division, two trap cages and 25 camera traps have been installed as per the instructions of the Principal Chief Conservator of Forests and Chief Wildlife Warden.”

A special team comprising forest staff has been formed to track and monitor the animal. The department confirmed that the tiger being searched for in Vimalagiri is different to the one that killed two people in O’Valley in August.

Dr. Radhakrishnan Award presented to 396 teachers in T.N.



Minister Rajmohan presenting an award to a teacher at the Anna Centenary Library in Chennai on Saturday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

On the occasion of Teachers’ Day on Saturday, the Tamil Nadu government honoured 396 teachers across the State with the Dr. Radhakrishnan Award at the Anna Centenary Library in Chennai.

Speaking at the event, School Education Minister Rajmohan said: “TN-Arivu (curriculum) must be taken to every street of the

Deadlock over release and extradition of convicted antique dealer Subash Kapoor

He was extradited from Germany to India in 2012 to face trial in an idol theft case in Ariyalur district; he was convicted and sentenced to 10 years in jail; while State govt. wants to prosecute him in more cases, the Centre says India should honour its extradition treaties with Germany and the U.S.

R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

A deadlock has emerged over the release and extradition of international antique dealer Subash Chandra Kapoor, who has been lodged at the Tiruchi Central Prison. The State government has insisted that he should not be released and extradited, as he faces prosecution in five more cases in Tamil Nadu. However, the Centre has maintained that India should honour its extradition treaties with Germany and the United States.

Kapoor, a U.S. national, was cited as accused in a case booked by the Udayarpalayam police in Ariyalur district in 2008 on charges of burglary and illegal export of 19 antique idols valued over ₹94 crore to the Art of the Past gallery in New York owned by him. He was detained by the German Police on October 30, 2011, at Cologne Airport based on a Red Corner Notice issued by Interpol. In 2012, he was

handed over at the Cologne Airport to the Idol Wing CID. Kapoor was extradited to India to face charges in the Udayarpalayam case, in pursuance of the extradition treaty between India and Germany. After the extradition of Kapoor, the trial was conducted by the Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate Court, Kumbakonam, and Kapoor was convicted and sentenced to imprisonment of 10 years. The period of imprisonment was completed by Kapoor on March 22, 2023. However, Kapoor continued to be lodged in the Tiruchi Central Prison as he was formally arrested in four more idol theft cases reported at the Vikramangalam, Vriddhachalam, Palavoor, and Veervanallur police stations.

The Tamil Nadu government sought the consent of German authorities through the Union Ministries of Home Affairs and External Affairs on July 6, 2023 to prosecute Kapoor in the four cases in which the Idol Wing CID has filed



Behind bars: Though Kapoor completed his sentence in March 2023, he continued to be lodged in the Tiruchi Central Prison as he was formally arrested in four more idol theft cases. FILE PHOTO

chargesheets against him in the courts.

Under such circumstances, in a recently filed affidavit in a court proceeding, the Union Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) submitted that the Federal Republic of Germany had December 20, 2023 not agreed to the proposed extension of the prosecution. It added that it had recently (last July) received proposals again from the Tamil Nadu government for obtaining the consent of Germany in 10 cases. However, Germany had refused to grant consent to prosecute Kapoor

pean nation had reiterated that further prosecution was not permissible under the principle of speciality. The MEA sought the release of Kapoor from detention so that he could be produced before the Extradition Court-Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Patiala House, in order to initiate extradition inquiry.

Opposing the plea to release Kapoor, the Idol Wing CID said Kapoor was the mastermind behind a massive global antiquities smuggling network that had looted thousands of ancient idols from Tamil Nadu temples. He had orchestrated a highly organised criminal conspiracy that falsified provenance and laundered stolen heritage. The Extradition Act, 1962, and the Indo-Germany Treaty allow the prosecution for other offences.

“Germany extradited Kapoor only to India pursuant to India’s request under the treaty. Therefore, India is bound by the conditions attached to Germany’s extradition order and by the Rule of Speciality. A

further extradition (re-extradition) from India to the U.S. is not automatic. Under international extradition law and the treaty, a person extradited from Germany cannot ordinarily be surrendered by India to a third state (U.S.),” the Idol Wing CID countered, reiterating its stand.

Sources in the Idol Wing CID said only 25 of 56 antique idols in which Kapoor was involved were repatriated to Tamil Nadu. Twelve were traced to various places abroad and under the process of repatriation, while 19 were yet to be traced. So, Kapoor needed to be interrogated.

In the meantime, Kapoor has filed a *habeas corpus* petition in the Madurai Bench of Madras High Court seeking an order to the State and Central authorities to direct his immediate release from illegal custody and repatriation to his native country. The Union Home Secretary has also written to the Director-General of Police, Tamil Nadu, on the matter, it is learnt.

EC bars ex-MLA Aassan Maulaana from contesting elections for three years

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Election Commission of India (EC) has disqualified J.M.H. Aassan Maulaana, who was elected from the Velachery Assembly constituency in Chennai on a Congress ticket in the 2021 Assembly election, from contesting elections for a period of three years from August 2026.

According to the EC’s order, the disqualification bars Mr. Maulaana from contesting elections to become a member of either House of Parliament or the Legislative Assembly or Legislative Council of a State or Union Territory.

The order said he failed to lodge a true and correct account of his election expenses within the time and in the manner required under the Representation of



J.M.H. Aassan Maulaana

the People Act, 1951.

Mr. Maulaana had lodged his account of election expenses, declaring a total expenditure of ₹17,03,548, with the District Election Officer (DEO), Chennai, on May 24, 2021, within the prescribed time.

However, the EC said the Returning Officer had issued a notice to Mr. Maulaana on March 30, 2021, raising the issue of wheth-

er advertisements published by the Tamil Nadu Congress Committee (TNCC) in 10 newspapers were intended to promote his election.

On March 31, 2021, Mr. Maulaana informed the EC that the TNCC had borne the stated advertisement expenses independently. However, the DEO, Chennai, in his scrutiny report on June 19, 2021, did not accept the account and determined that there had been an understatement of ₹32,05,915 in respect of the advertisements, the order said.

The Commission said with the understated amount of ₹32,05,915 added to the declared expenditure of ₹17,03,548, the total expenditure came to ₹49,09,463, exceeding the then permissible ceiling of ₹30.80 lakh.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

At the second meeting of the post-poll allies of the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), scheduled to be held at the party headquarters in Panaiyur on the outskirts of Chennai on September 9, the TVK is expected to formalise the alliance headed by it in the State.

TVK president and Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay will hold discussions with leaders of the Congress, IUML, VCK, and the MDMK on formalising the existing alliance in the State. The TVK has already reached out to the Left parties and MDMK general secretary Vaiko, extending formal invitations to participate in the meeting.

On Saturday, senior TVK



Strengthening ties: Ministers N. Anand and Aadhav Arjuna calling on TNCC president B. Manickam Tagore and Rajya Sabha Member Praveen Chakravarty at Satyamurthy Bhavan on Saturday.

leaders, including Ministers N. Anand and Aadhav Arjuna, met Tamil Nadu Congress Committee (TNCC) president B. Manickam Tagore and Rajya Sabha member Praveen Chakravarty at Satyamurthy Bhavan, the headquarters of the TNCC in Chennai, to extend a formal

invitation to the meeting.

Later, they met VCK president Thol. Thirumavalavan at the party headquarters in Ashok Nagar in the city. Mr. Arjuna said the party leaders would meet IUML national president K.M. Khader Mohideen on September 8 and invite him to the second meeting.

79 monoliths and a mountain of challenges

K. Muralitharan
CHENNAI

The fire-ravaged Veera Vasantharayar Mandapam at the Meenakshi Amman Temple in Madurai has risen anew, though its reconstruction was fraught with immense challenges.

Adjoining the temple’s eastern tower (*Kizhaku Gopuram*), the hall suffered catastrophic damage in a massive fire on February 2, 2018. Following the disaster, devotee access to the area was restricted, and the decision was made to undertake a complete restoration. Under the AIADMK government, the project was initially planned at an estimated cost of ₹18.10 crore. However, sourcing the right granite stones caused severe delays. Eventually, stones from Pattam village in Rasipuram taluk of Namakkal district were selected. Subsequently, litigation, the COVID-19 pandemic, and procedural



Restoration drive: The Veera Vasantharayar Mandapam, which has been rebuilt after it was damaged in a fire on February 2, 2018, at the Meenakshi Amman Temple in Madurai. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

hurdles in finalising contracts stalled the project even further.

When the DMK came to power in 2021, the budget allocation was revised upward to ₹38.30 crore. The responsibility for sculpting the pillars was entrusted to *sthapathi* V.P. Velmurugan of Tiruppur, who spoke to *The Hindu* about the uphill battle the restoration posed. “Even though the

contract was finalised early in the DMK regime, the arrival of the stone blocks was delayed. Sculpting work eventually commenced at Koodal Sengulam village near the Madurai airport,” Mr. Velmurugan said.

Located adjacent to the eastern tower of the Meenakshi Amman Temple, the Veera Vasantharayar Mandapam was built in

1611 CE by Muthu Veerappa Nayak, the brother of King Thirumalai Nayak. It was constructed after the renowned Thousand Pillar Mandapam. Within this hall, a Nandi facing the Swami (Sundareswarar) shrine is situated inside a stone cistern; this Nandi dates back to the Early Pandya period.

The 2018 blaze levelled large sections of the hall. Every pillar in the ruined area was extensively photographed before being dismantled. Out of the 136 pillars in and around the mandapam, 79 have been completely carved anew.

Massive project

Neither Mr. Velmurugan nor his team had ever undertaken a project of this magnitude. “Between 2012-13, we built the *prakara mandapam* at the Uthirakosamangai Mangalanathar Temple, but it was nowhere near this scale,” he said. A crew of around 150 sculptors was mobil-

ised. For most of them, working at this scale was completely unprecedented, leaving the project timeline shrouded in uncertainty at the outset.

“We carved a total of 79 new pillars,” Mr. Velmurugan explained. “Each shaft stood 18.6 feet tall, and with capital elements such as the lion motifs added, each finished column reached 29 feet. Sculpting pillars of this scale was an enormous challenge in itself, but the logistical hurdles that followed were just as steep. Finding cranes capable of lifting and erecting massive corner pillars such as the *Karnakkal* proved exceedingly difficult. Several crane operators inspected the site and walked away. It was only after days of searching that we secured the right heavy-duty cranes to hoist the pillars into place,” he recalled.

The reconstructed mandapam was formally inaugurated on August 30.

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NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM
Website-www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in
Date: 04-09-2026
Under noted amendment is hereby made against tender No. (i)22261811A due on 07-09-2026 (ii)28260904 due on 07-09-2026 & Tender Notice No. 07 dt. 15-07-2026 (Item No. 01 & 03)
Item No.-01, Item Description:- Tender Opening date with time, Existing Entry: 07-09-2026 11:30 am, Amended as: 13-10-2026 11:30 am,
Item No.-03, Item Description:- Tender Opening date with time, Existing Entry: 07-09-2026 11:30 am, Amended as: 03-11-2026 11:30 am,
Description may be viewed at IREPS website.
All other terms and conditions will be remain unchanged.
Note: Above information may be seen on N.E. Railway website www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in & Govt. of India's website www.tenders.gov.in
Principal Chief Material Manager, CPRO/S-51 Gorakhpur
Never travel on roof and foot boards.

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM
Website-www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in
Date: 04-09-2026
Under noted amendment is hereby made against tender No. (i)22261964 due on 24-09-2026 (ii)29265315 due on 03-09-2026 & Tender Notice No. 09 dt. 17-08-2026 (Item No. 06 & 24)
Item No.-06, Item Description:- Tender Opening date with time, Existing Entry: 24-09-2026 11:30 am, Amended as: 26-10-2026 11:30 am,
Item No.-24, Item Description:- Tender Opening date with time, Existing Entry: 03-09-2026 11:30 am, Amended as: 10-09-2026 11:30 am,
Description may be viewed at IREPS website.
All other terms and conditions will be remain unchanged.
Note: Above information may be seen on N.E. Railway website www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in & Govt. of India's website www.tenders.gov.in
Principal Chief Material Manager, CPRO/S-52 Gorakhpur
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ICMR-NATIONAL INSTITUTE FOR VECTOR CONTROL RESEARCH
INDIRA NAGAR, MEDICAL COMPLEX
PUDUCHERRY- 605 006
Date: 06.09.2026
VACANCY CIRCULAR – SECTION OFFICER
DATED 06.08.2026
Applications are invited from eligible employees of Central/State Government Departments/Autonomous Bodies/ PSUs for 03 posts of Section Officer (Pay Level-7: Rs. 44,900 –1,42,400) on Deputation Basis, including Short Term Contract, at ICMR-National Institute for Vector Control Research (ICMR-NIVCR), Puducherry.
Post Code: S-12 | No. of Vacancies: 03
For eligibility criteria, terms and application form, please refer to Vacancy Circular: Recruitment of Section Officer (Pay Level-7) on Deputation Basis (including short term contract) at ICMR Headquarters/Institutes/Centres in the official ICMR website <https://icmr.gov.in>, and <https://vcrcc.icmr.org.in>.

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM
Website: www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in Dated: 03.09.2026
Under noted amendment is hereby made against tender No. 22261371 due on 02.09.2026 & T. Notice No. 05 dt. 15.06.2026 (Item No. 02), Item No.-02, Item Description -Tender Opening Date with time, Existing Entry:- 02.09.2026 11:30 am, Amended as :- 09.10.2026 11:30 am, Description may be viewed at IREPS website. All other terms and conditions will be remain unchanged.
Note: Above information may be seen on N.E. Railway Website www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in & Govt. of India's website www.tenders.gov.in
CPRO/S-49 SMM/IC
"Never travel on roof and foot boards"

Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli
E-Tender Notice no.- ELECT-PS-20595
On behalf of the President of India, Dy., Chief Electrical Engineer/PS, Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli is inviting open e-tender, based on single packet system from capable & experienced tenderers through Indian Railways portal www.ireps.gov.in for the under mentioned work on prescribed tender format.
Details:- 1. Name of Work: Alternate power supply arrangement for FWP from 33/11kV Substation of MCF. 2. Place of work: Modern Coach Factory Lalganj, Distt. Raebareli. 3. Approx. cost: Rs. 2,48,90,382.87 (Two Crore Forty Eight Lakh Ninety Thousand Three Hundred Eighty Two Rupees And Eighty Seven Paise Only). 4. Earnest money: Rs. 4,97,800.00 (Four Lakh Ninety Seven Thousand Eight Hundred Rupees Only). 5. Period of completion: 09 (Nine months). 6. Date & Time of closing of tender: 22.09.2026 at 15.00 hrs. 7. Term & Condition: Other details, terms & condition are available in tender documents on www.ireps.gov.in.
E-Tender Notice No. 05/2026-27 (Open) of DyCE-II/MCF/RBL - Corrigenum
With reference to E-Tender Notice No.-05/2026-27 (Open) of DyCE-II/MCF/RBL, it is hereby informed that the tender no. is modified as under:
Particulars Existing Tender No. Modified Tender No.
Tender No. 10-2026-27 10-2026-27-RT
Deputy Chief Engineer-II
SERVICE CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

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Principal Chief Material Manager, CPRO/S-52 Gorakhpur
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कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, देवघर
अत्यकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
ई- निविदा सूचना संख्या – RDD/SD/DEOGHAR/01/2026-27
1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी:
क्र० एवं युप सं० कार्य का नाम प्राक्कलित राशि अग्रघन की राशि परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1 देवघर जिला के पालोजोरी प्रखंड अन्तर्गत पंचायत महुआडाबर आगगाछी जोरिया में पुल निर्माण। 1,35,45,403.82 2,71,000.00 10000.00 15 माह
2 देवघर जिला के पालोजोरी प्रखंड अन्तर्गत पंचायत बसहा में जमुआ से तेलंगा रोड में पुल निर्माण (तेलंगा मोड जोड़ने का मार्ग है) 1,67,99,228.62 3,36,000.00 10000.00 15 माह
3 देवघर जिला के सारत प्रखंड अन्तर्गत पंचायत कचुवाबॉक से गोपलारायडीह के बीच जोरिया में पुल निर्माण। 1,66,34,972.63 3,32,700.00 10000.00 15 माह
2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 09.09.2026
3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक 10.09.2026 से दिनांक 24.09.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, देवघर
5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय – 26.09.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे
6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, देवघर
7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 8292390365 (संबंधित कार्यपालक अभियंता का दूरभाष नम्बर)
8. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी। विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।
कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, देवघर।
PR.NO.389107 Rural Development(26-27):D

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RENTAL – COMMERCIAL

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2747 SQFT commercial space for rent in Athipattu, Ambattur Ind-estate -9940363443

PADAPPAI –400M from Jamal Ice Cream, 10,560 Sq.Ft. Vacant Land, 2-side road, suitable for warehouse. Ph: 93429 12619

AYAPAKKAM OPPO ICMR Bus route 400 sft Shop with toilet. Rent:16K for office / consultation 9839136042

PERUNGUDI (OMR)
Nehru Nagar 7690sqft, Independent Building, Gr-2, Fully Furnished, 100 Work Stations, 7 Cabins, 2 Conference Hall, Centrally Air Conditioned, Power Backup, Server Room, Fire Exit, Car / 2 wheeler Parking. **Ct: 9840028833**

KODAMBAKKAM STN Rd 1279 St Gr.Fr Prime. Rs.100/- Per Sft. 98402030350

NUNGAMBAKKAM NEAR Taj still+4 new commercial building for rent 50K Sft. 9840085898/9840033693

COMMERCIAL SPACE –Anna Ngr East Available for Rent Ground/Fr 1360Sqft, 1st Fr-1360Sqft, 2nd Fr-3980Sqft. Fully Furnished.Ct: 9840181108

OMR THURAIAPPAKKAM Parallel Rd, Kottaima Ngr, 450sft (10x45) 984111452

T.NAGAR SOUTH Boag Rd Indpt Bldg 6000sft Gr-2 Vastu N/E Corner/False Ceiling, 6 Air-Con, 3 Car Parking, Rent 5 Lakhs.7338779689 9869164779

ROYAPETTAH 5 BHK Individual House Spacious 4,000 Sq.ft Ground / First Floor & Second floor Terrace Garden, Suitable for Office-cum-Residence, Doctors, CAs and other Commercial Uses. 3 Car Parkings, UPS, CCTV, Terrace. Rent: Rs.1.30 Lakhs p.m. Contact: 98845 91133

STANDALONE OFFICE Building for Rent @ T.Nagar – 7 Cabins, 3 Meeting rooms, 2 Conference rooms, 50 Seater, Fully furnished, Ample parking, 6600 sqft. Pls contact 9841062626, 9840426263

NOOMBAL PRIME Area 28,000sft Gr-2 Fr for Rent Suitable MNC, Corporate Office, Warehouse Ct: 9841723469

MADIPAKKAM PRIME Location Nrf KFC Commercial Space for Rent 6G 1350sqft Suitable for Supermarket, Instantamr/Swiggy, Clinics, Etc 994 3333 997

WEST TAMBARAKM Mudichur Road 1300sft G.Fr Shop Rent 1.35Lac 9841008598

RESTAURANT SPACE Available @ Sekaram Mall Near swimming pool with open Terrace & Closed Space. Already 40 Rooms Running. Ct: 9176618808

ADYAR NEHRU Ngr Near Nall, 1850sft Fr Showroom/Office. 8050sft36789

ASHOK NAGAR 4th Ave,1100 &2000sft F.Furn 2nd Fr. 40Wok Shop. SIn:9841483939

RENTAL – COMMERCIAL

OFFICE SPACE For Rent Omr Perumbakkam 2000Sft Room Partitions Available Rs.1L Onwards.Ct : 9176618808

AMBATTUR INDUSTRIAL ESTATE
Newly Built Industrial Shed Size 150 Ft x 80 Ft, Built on a 5 Grounds Plot with 20T EOT Crane. Immediate Occupation. **Contact 9500155338 / 9840912664**

VANAGARAM 26000 Sft Shed for Rent CT :Raja mannar 9841295956

LITTLE MOUNT Near Metro Station 3000 Sqft Commercial Space available for Rent Ct: 9150001111 / 9597088433

MARAMALAI NAGAR 40000-120000sft Plug& Play Industrial Shed 9150212075

40,000-2,00,000SQ.FT SHEDS Available Near Sicily, A.P. Ct: 7448324832

SRIPERUMBUDUR NEARBY VALARPURAM Industrial/Warehouse 1.62Acres Land, Shed Builtup 44000sft Ct: 9940095075

GUEST HOUSE
40,000-2,00,000SQ.FT SHEDS Available Near Sicily, A.P. Ct: 7448324832

3000SFT Ground Fr Comm Hall Rent 30820sft Rd Purasawalkam. 9884123450

AMBATUR – Puzhal Road, 1700sft, 850 sft Showroom. Ct: 9884989394

ANNANAGAR PLAZA (L) Shop 33 G.F, 200Sft. A/C/Fr. 3PH, 35K 9840190109

790SFT FURNISHED Office Cabin WS TNgr Nr Pondybaraz 3Ft Lift CP 9444116320

Porur Fully Furnished IT Office Space 1600 sq.ft P&P in 1st Floor available on Ganesha Ave, Skathi Nagar. Call: 9824207955

MADHAVARAM On Mndr Opp Shell 1200sft 2nd Fr Lift&2whlr Park 9381017428

VADAPALAI, 100 FL.Rd, GF1500 sft, Basement 2000 sft, Bank, Mini Hall, Hotels. Ct: 9543436282/ 893930988

BRAND NEW Grade A Warehouse for sale with Corporate tenan70,000 Sq ft 7% ROI Ct: Raymond NK 9940045008

KORATTUR PRIME Road-Facing Subway Ser.Rd 30083000sft G.Fr Rent Suitable Bank/Office Showroom Retail/Clinic, Car/Bike Parking 9841297991

Dark Store Space available at Chengalpattu Contact: 9568280012

Commercial Space Ready to Occupy Office/ Bank/ Clinic/ Showroom/ 1650 sft Sriperumbudur, First Floor no.5 car street Contact: 9894041006

Ready-to-Occupy Fully Furnished Office Space (4330 Sqft) with premium Interior available for Rent at Navins Presidium Aminjikarai. Call: 9840256987 / 9840755564

ASHOKNAGAR OFFICE, 1ST Avenue 100' Road 1600sft Plug & Play with 44 Work Station, 1 Conference, 2 Manager Cabin, 1 MD Cabin, 5th flr, full AC DG Backup. Ct Owner: 9940043958

INJAMBAKKAM

ECR 4BHK Villa, Servant Quarters–Outside, 4844 sqft, 2 Car Parkings, No Brokers. 93855 93339/ 94440 18656

KODAMBAKKAM
TRUSTPURAM Nr SS Biryani, 2BHK, 3rd floor, OCP, Lift, Rent: 32K, Advance: 6 months. Ct: 98408 06282

PALLAVARAM
2BHK APT 950sft 1st Floor Lift OCP available Ct: 9841725669/9941410011

PALLIKARANAI
FLAT LEASE LIC Nagar, Pallikaranai 1BHK 585sqft 9500145732, 8825519669

3BHK RAJPARIS Apts.4th floor, South facing , CCP, Rent 73974 12399

PERUNGUDI
2100 SFT IND villa 3.1 BHK 2 car park backside of Global Info City Park opp lake. Rent :43K + Maint. 98849 66968

OMR-PERUNGUDI 18K Fully Furnish Only for Bachelors.12000/pm. 9841007599

PORUR
Alappakam Main Road Near Porur 2BHK Flat in Elements II, Exclusive Senior Citizens' community, Well maintained, ready for immediate Occupancy. Peaceful surroundings with all amenities. Senior Citizens Only. Contact: 94441 0546

R A PURAM
KARPAGAM AVENUE 10/38 I Street Ground Fr 1200sft 3BHK CCP. 9790953062

ROYAPETTAH
BALAJI Nagar 2BHK NF 1500 SF 1 CP Lift SEC 55K Contact: 8148914010

SHOLINGANALLUR
VAIKUND APT 3BHK 3Bath 1820sft S.Fu r CCP, Lift, M.Kitchen 94457 23588

T NAGAR
OFF- BAZULLA Rd 2New Posh 3BHK, 2200sft, S.Furn 2CCP, DG, 1Flat/ Floor Suits Corp/Mntl No Bkr. 9500045750

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✓ SOUTH AVENUE- PROXIMITY TO SCHOOLS/IT PARKS- NEW 1500 Sq.ft, 3 BHK, 4th FLR CLASSY FLAT- INTERIOR: S/PLT AC/S/LIFT /GENERATOR/ 2 CCP Rs 70000/- Ct: 9840056657 / 9841612221

WANTED FOR rent 2BHK flat / house in Triplicane. Contact: 93810 41369

URAPPAKKAM
URAPPAKKAM 3BHK 1000 sq.ft House for Rent. Call: 9441298673, 9841298673

VALASARAWALKAM
FULLY FURNISHED 2BHK Flat 800sft in Arcot Road Suitable for Students & IT professionals Ct : 99400 83013

VENKATESA NGR I Main Rd Extn II- 2BHK 1100Sft G.F CCP for Rent. Rs.25000. Family Only. No Bkr. 9087064506

WANTED FOR rent 2BHK flat / house in Egmore. Contact: 93810 41369

GUINDY 2400 Sq.ft 4 Bedroom Flat With Study, G AC, FCP, Lift Rent Rs. 65000/- . Sujatha- 8144929800

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PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

MY SON, K G MUHUNDHAN, S/o. Govindaraj N, Date of Birth: 16-Dec-2011, residing at No.22-G, 2nd Floor, Indus Anantya Apts, Nattham Link Road, Navalur, Chennai 603103, shall henceforth be known as G SREE MUKUNDAN vide affidavit dated 29-Aug-2026 at Chennai. - Govindar

Tragic accident raises safety concerns along highway in Keralam

The Hindu Bureau
THRISSUR

The death of eight engineering students from Tamil Nadu in Thrissur district of Keralam on Friday night has raised safety concerns along the accident-prone stretch of the National Highway 66.

The fatal crash left the car crushed and wedged beneath the stationary lorry, making it difficult for first responders to even reach it initially. “Only after the lorry was moved forward and the car was pulled out using a rope could we properly see it,” a local resident involved in the rescue operation said.

The deceased were identified as Prasanna R. from Viraganoor in Madurai; Joshua Hilson J. from Old Vilangudi in Madurai; Murali Krishnan M. from Vadipatti in Madurai; Yuva Sajith K. from Ottanchattam in Dindigul; Jeeva N. from V.T. Patti in Dindigul; G. Santhosh from Melur in Madurai; Surya I. from Adiyanthu in Dindigul; and V. Viswa from Pudunallakondanpatti in Salem.

Families in shock

By Saturday morning, the grieving families of the students had arrived at the mortuary complex in Thrissur Government Medical College Hospital. Amid sobs and, at times, stunned silence, the relatives waited for the post-mortem procedures to be completed. All the bodies were handed over to the families by afternoon.

According to Raj Kumar, Jeeva's brother, the eight friends had planned a one-day trip to celebrate Santhosh's recent purchase of a car. However, they did not make the trip in the new car, but had hired a rental vehicle for the journey, he said. The families of most of the students were reportedly unaware that they had gone on the trip.

23 deaths in 10 years

Local residents alleged that the under-construction highway presented several safety concerns, including a lack of signboards at several diversion points, illegal parking on the road, and several stretches that are not properly lit.

They said as many as three accidents occurred in the same spot in the last three days. As many as 23 lives were lost in the 10 years, they alleged.

“The under-construction highway has become extremely dangerous. There are stretches without proper warning boards or traffic-management measures. Illegal parking and speeding are adding to the risk. Many of the stretches on the NH 66 do not have proper lighting,” said social activist Latheef Kettummal.

Thrissur Rural Police chief Mohammed Nadeemuddin said investigators were examining all circumstances surrounding the crash, including the possibility of safety lapses on the part of highway authorities.

TCS to establish ₹70,000-cr. AI data centre in Hyderabad

TCS subsidiary HyperVault will develop a large-scale data centre with a capacity of 1 gigawatt; Telangana CM calls it ‘largest AI data centre in the country’, seeks completion before June 2028

R. Ravikanth Reddy
HYDERABAD

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy on Saturday announced ₹70,000-crore investment by the Tata Group, TCS and HyperVault in Hyderabad, Telangana, that would create the largest data centre in the country, creating direct employment to 7,000 people.

The Chief Minister has set a deadline of June 2, 2028, the Telangana Formation Day, for the inauguration of what he described as India's largest AI data centre. “From groundbreaking to inauguration, exactly 21 months from today, on June 2, 2028, we want to inaugurate India's largest AI data centre,” he said.

As per the announcement, TCS subsidiary HyperVault will develop a large-scale AI data centre campus with capacity of up to 1 gigawatt. TCS CEO and Managing Director K.



Tech ties: TCS CEO K. Krithivasan with Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy in Hyderabad on Saturday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

‘Vizag hub to use air-cooling tech’

VISAKHAPATANAM

Amid concerns over high water consumption of the Google data centre coming up in Visakhapatnam, M. Sriharat, MP, said the facility would use air-cooling and not water. “Google has confirmed it will use air-cooling technology... there is no question of impact to water supply,” he said.

The Chief Minister assured investors that Telangana would maintain continuity in its investment policies despite changes in governments. “Political and ideological differences will not affect the investment policy,” he said.

Karnataka honours teachers with title ‘Tr’

The Hindu Bureau
KALABURAGI

Like “Dr” for doctors and “Prof” for professors, teachers in Karnataka can now prefix their names with the title “Tr”.

The Karnataka government made the announcement on the occasion of Teachers’ Day. The order highlights multiple contributions of teachers – ranging from career guidance and instilling confidence

among students to upholding Constitutional values and building a scientific temper.

Speaking at an event in Kudligi on Saturday, which coincided with Teachers’ Day, Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar said: “There are more than 4.5 lakh teachers in Karnataka. A mother who gives us life and a teacher who gives us education are invaluable and deserve special honour,” he said.

Keralam Cong. MLA, party cadre booked

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Hardly a day after a scuffle broke out between Congress MLA Ramya Haridas and local party workers at Chirayinkeezhu in Thiruvananthapuram, Keralam, the Chirayinkeezhu police on Saturday registered cases against the MLA and Congress workers.

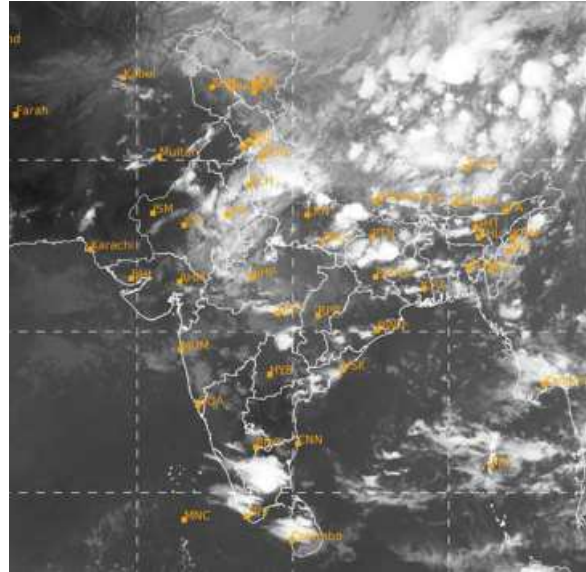
The police registered a case against 15 Congress workers based on Ms. Hari-

das's statement. A separate case has also been registered against the MLA based on a complaint filed by a Congress worker, the police said.

Ms. Haridas alleged that she was manhandled by local Congress leaders over a WhatsApp post. But district panchayat member Sajith Muttambalam and party local leader Sajad alleged that the MLA and her associates had confronted them over the post.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



Forecast for Sunday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Rajasthan, Chandigarh, Delhi, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim and Madhya Pradesh. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		33.4	25.7	Kurnool		36.0	26.2
Ahmedabad		32.5	25.8	Lucknow		33.4	25.8
Aizawl		30.5	23.3	Madurai		41.8	37.3
Bengaluru	12.6	31.7	20.8	Mangaluru		31.6	23.7
Bhopal		55	25.2	Mumbai		0.4	32.1
Bhubaneswar		35.6	25.4	Mysuru		34.0	19.2
Chandigarh	50.5	31.7	23.7	New Delhi		37.3	27.6
Chennai		36.3	26.8	Patna		8.7	30.9
Coimbatore		34.3	23.1	Port Blair		9.4	29.5
Dehradun	5.2	28.5	23.2	Prayagraj		32.6	25.6
Gangtok		58	22.6	Puducherry		0.2	34.6
Goa		3.2	31.6	Pune		2	29.8
Guwahati		0.8	33.8	Raipur		0.5	30.2
Hubballi		31.0	21.0	Ranchi		0.2	27.8
Hyderabad		32.6	24.4	Shillong		0.6	24.3
Imphal		31.3	22.6	Shimla		1.4	24.3
Jaipur		18.8	27.4	Srinagar			26.6
Kochi		31.0	26.2	Thiruvananthapuram			33.0
Kohima		25.6	19.0	Tiruchirappalli			40.7
Kolkata		33.2	27.0	Vijayawada			39.1
Kozhikode		33.8	25.9	Visakhapatnam			34.0

CITY	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad		72		35			In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Cuddalore
Bengaluru		21		42			Tamil Nadu recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 493
Chennai		4		33			indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Karwar, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 16
Delhi		30		24			
Hyderabad		12		12			
Kolkata		9		39			
Lucknow		14		22			
Mumbai		5		147			
Pune		14		17			
Visakhapatnam		24		65			

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and significant cultural important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

Attained Sivan Thiruvadi

Loganathan Kandasamy (80)
1946 - 2026

Retired Principal
Tamil Nadu Government
M.G.R. Film and Television Institute,
Tharamani, Chennai

Attained Sivan Thiruvadi on
28.08.2026 (DOD)
Shodasa Kariyam (16th day ceremony) on
12.09.2026

In his loving memory

Wife : Padmavathi K
Daughter : Sammathi Abirami K.L
Son : Manikandan K.L
and Relatives

☎ Ct: 8939994633 or 9176663080

DEATH

In Loving Memory

Sri. Nandlal Kishindas Nichani
27.02.1942 - 04.09.2026

With profound grief, we regret to inform the demise of

Chautha Prayer Meet will be held on Monday 07.09.2026
4.30pm - 5.00pm at Sindhu Sadan, Egmore.

Fondly remembered by

Sons and Daughters-in-Law
Vijay & Nithya Nichani
Santosh & Anjna Nichani
Grandchildren

Daughters and Sons-in-law
Varsha & Baldev Chhabria
Preethi & Kamal Daswani
& the entire Nichani Family

Residence 1A, Krishna Nivas,
14th Avenue, Harrington Road, Chetpet, Chennai

DEATH

Shri Ashokkumar Kantilal Modi - 58,
Kasturi Rangan Road, Alwarpet,
Chennai - 600018 attained Vishnu
Thiruvadi on 4th September 2026. He
is survived by wife Smt Uma Ashokku-
mar Modi, daughter Urvi Snehal Shah
and son Apurva A Modi - Cremation
on 6th September, 2026 at 10.00 AM

DEATH

SAD DEMISE

Shri. BALAKRISHNAN
on 5th September 2026

His loving presence, guidance and cherished
memories will remain with us forever.
May his soul rest in eternal peace.

The funeral will be held on 6th September 2026 at 10:30 a.m.,
at the residence of the deceased.

Ramesh and Jyothi

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

8TH ANNIVERSARY

K. ARUNKUMAR
S.O.S. KRISHNAMURTHI
(Retd. Chief Engineer, PWD)
22nd Aug 1965 - 6th Sept 2018

Minutes passed, hours passed,
days passed, weeks passed,
months passed and now eight
years have passed too.
But not a single second passes
without your thoughts.

*Fondly remembered by
Family & Friends*

25th ANNIVERSARY

V.N.SAMA RAO B.Sc., B.L.
Advocate, Vellore

Birth: 30.03.1931 Death: 06.09.2001

*"An extraordinary soul
Lived for principles
Leading us every moment"*

Fondly remembered by:
VALLUR FAMILY MEMBERS

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

Website-www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in
date 04.08.2026

Under noted amendment is hereby
made against tender No. (I)21250058
due on 22.09.2026 (ii) 21260041 due
on 14.09.2026 (iii) 21260102 due on
08.09.2026 (iv) 22262087 due on
28.08.2026 & Tender Notice No. 08 dt.
31.07.2026 (Item No. 02, 03, 05 & 13)

Item no.02, Item Description-Tender
Opening date with time: Existing Entry-
22.09.2026 11:30 am, Amended as-
12.11.2026 11:30 am

Item no.03, Item Description-Tender
Opening date with time: Existing Entry-
14.09.2026 11:30 am, Amended as-
09.11.2026 11:30 am

Item no.05, Item Description-Tender
Opening date with time: Existing Entry-
08.09.2026 11:30 am, Amended as-
15.10.2026 11:30 am

Item no.13, Item Description-Tender
Opening date with time: Existing Entry-
28.08.2026 11:30 am, Amended as-
08.10.2026 11:30 am

Description may be viewed at
IREPS website. All other terms and
condition will be remain unchanged.
Note: Above information may be
seen on N.E. Railway Website
www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in & Govt.
of India's website www.tenders.gov.in
Principal Chief Material Manager
CPRO/S-53 Gorakhpur

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-
Port Blair - Rs. 15/-

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
DEPARTMENT OF ENVIRONMENT, CLIMATE CHANGE AND FORESTS
TAMIL NADU FOREST AND WILDLIFE CRIME CONTROL BUREAU

TNFWCCB Notification No. 01/2026, Dated:03.09.2026

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for **selection and appointment to various posts in the Tamil Nadu Forest and Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (TNFWCCB)**, purely on a contractual basis, at the Office of the Conservator of Forests and Director, Tamil Nadu Forest and Wildlife Crime Control Bureau, Saidapet, Chennai-15.

Eligible candidates are requested to submit their applications online through the official TNFWCCB portal: <https://tnfwccb.com/recruitment/> on or before **19.09.2026**. For Enquiry: Toll Free: 1800 599 7699. Email : tnfwccb@gmail.com

Applications submitted through the above-mentioned website alone shall be considered for selection.

**Conservator of Forests & Director,
Tamil Nadu Forest and Wildlife Crime
Control Bureau, Chennai.**

DIPR/778/Display/2026

GOVERNMENT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH,
DEPARTMENT OF REVENUE
(HPDRRP Program)

(Program Management Unit)
Shanti Niwas, Phase -3, Kangnadhar, Shimla (H.P.)-171009
Phone No. 0177-2921430, e-mail: hpdrrp-afd@hp.gov.in

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

The Himachal Pradesh State Disaster Management Authority (HPSDMA) invites Request for Proposals (RFPs) under the Himachal Pradesh Disaster Risk Reduction and Preparedness (HPDRRP) Program for the following:

Sr. 1. Empanelment of Travel Management Companies/Firms/Agencies to provide travel management and logistical support for official domestic and international travel, exposure visits, training programmes, study tours, accommodation, transportation, visa assistance, and related services.

Sr. 2. Selection of Firm(s) for providing Program Audit Services in respect of Anti-Money Laundering (AML) and Countering the Financing of Terrorism (CFT) due diligence under the HPDRRP Program.

The detailed RFP document(s) are available on the HP eProcurement Portal (<https://hptenders.gov.in>). Interested agencies may submit their proposals online. Firms are advised to regularly visit and <https://hptenders.gov.in> for corrigenda and updates.

Last date for submission of proposals:

- o Sr. 1: **29 September 2026, up to 2:00 PM**
- o Sr. 2: **29 September 2026, up to 3:00 PM**

The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all proposals without assigning any reason thereof.

**-sd/- Nishant Thakur (HPAS)
Program Director
HPDRRP Program**

HP / 0860/2026-2027

MSME TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE CHENNAI
Government of India Autonomous Body
CFTI, 65/1, G.S.T. Road, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032

**Certified Professional Course on
LEAN SIX SIGMA CERTIFICATION
AI POWERED WORKSHOPS**

COURSE	FEES (incl GST)	CLASSROOM TRAINING DATES
YELLOW BELT	₹ 5,900	12 & 13 September 2026
GREEN BELT	₹ 17,700	12, 13, 19 & 20 September 2026
BLACK BELT (HYBRID)	₹ 29,500	12, 13, 19 & 20 Sept 3, 4, 10 & 11 October 2026

COURSE	FEES (incl GST)	ONLINE TRAINING DATES
SS AUDITOR (WEEKDAY)	₹ 7,375	16, 17, 18, 23, 24 & 25 September 2026
YELLOW BELT	₹ 2,950	26, 27 September 3 & 4 October 2026
GREEN BELT	₹ 14,750	26, 26 September 3, 4, 10, 11, 17 & 18 October 2026
BLACK BELT	₹ 22,125	26, 27 September 3, 4, 10, 11, 17, 18, 24 & 31 October 1 November 2026
ROOT CAUSE ANALYST (WEEKDAY)	₹ 2,950	12, 13, 14, 15 & 16 October 2026
LEAN CHAMPION (WEEKDAY)	₹ 7,375	14,15,16,21,22 & 23 October 2026

Timings : Classroom : 09.30 AM - 5 PM, Online : 07 PM - 10 PM Weekday Online : 8.00 PM - 10 PM
Classroom Venue: CFTI Block, 65/1, G.S.T Road, Guindy, Chennai - 32

LEAD TRAINER: Prof. Dr. Gopal Sivakumar,
M.E., Ph.D., CSSMBB, 20+ Years Exp. Founder & CEO, Vision Excellence

Call us for in-House Training Requirements:
APQP, PPAP, FMEA, SPC, MSA, IEC, DOCS, KAPEN, 8D, FMEA, KAPEN, MINIAS, QFD, DOE
Fees to be Paid through online www.cftitchennai.in Account No: 3868874350, IFSC Code: (Group Registration Offer Available for Corporates) SBIN0000958, Director, MSME TDC

For More Details Contact **90878 88225 | 88381 65936**
044 22501529 EXT 27 msmetdc@cftitchennai.in

A CH-CHE

Take unified stand on SIR, convene INDIA bloc meeting, says Dipankar

Mr. Bhattacharya further said that his party would contest the Assembly elections in Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand and Punjab. "If possible as part of the INDIA bloc, if a broader coalition emerges," he said, adding that if that does not happen, CPI(ML) Liberation would contest on its own or as part of the Left bloc.

“So far, in every State, the Opposition has responded to the SIR chal-

Mr. Suri said he subsequently learnt that the U.P. Police party had purportedly come pursuant to FIR No. 678/2026, Police Station Indirapuram, allegedly concerning Abhishek Upadhyay, and not any double-murder case as stated by the officer leading the search.

So, progressive thinking could take three paths: to reject all texts in their entirety, to repurpose them in progressive terms or to be agnostic about them. All paths have pros and cons, and there is no easy answer. M.K. Gandhi, an astute nation-builder, took the second path of reinterpreting the traditions for the modern world.

GREATER BENGALURU AUTHORITY Office of the Executive Engineer-6, 9th Floor, Jayanagara Shopping Complex, 4th Block, Jayanagara, Bengaluru-11	
No : EE-6/PIU/GBA/TEND/02/2026-27/Call-2	Date: 05.09.2026
INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER (IFT) (TWO COVER SYSTEM) (Only through KPP Portal) Call-2	
The Executive Engineer-6, PIU, G.B.A, Bangalore invites tenders from eligible Contractors registered in Greater Bengaluru Authority or equivalent registration with CPWD / KPWD / Railways / MES /National Highway or any State Government Organizations for the construction of works detailed in the table below. The Tenderers are advised to note the minimum qualification criteria specified in Clause 3 of the Instructions to Tenderers to qualify for award of the contract (Standard Tender Document - Kw4). 2. Tender documents may be downloaded from the GOK Karnataka Public Procurement portal From : 05.09.2026. 3. Other details can be seen in the tender document.	
Sl. No.	Name of the Work/Approximate Value of work (Rs in Lakhs)/ EMD amount in Rs.
1	Development of Hebbal Lake, Phase 2 (Call 2). Approximate Value of work : Rs. 1380.00 Lakhs, EMD : Rs. 13,80,000.00. Period of Completion : 9 Months (Including monsoon).
Calendar of events: 1.Pre-Bid Meeting is on 09.09.2026 at 15.00 hours at Office of the Chief Engineer, PIU, 9th Floor, Jayanagara Shopping Complex, 4th Block, Jayanagar, Bengaluru-560 011 2. Last Date for receipt of Tenders is on 18.09.2026 up to 16.00 hours. 3. Date of Opening of the Financial bid is on 19.09.2026 by 16.30 hours or next working day. 4. Date of Opening of Financial bid is after approval of Technical bid by competent Authority.	
Sd/- Executive Engineer - 6, Project Implementation Unit Greater Bengaluru Authority	

INBRIEF



EMMANUAL YOGINI

Seven-year-old dies during dahi handi in Mumbai

A seven-year-old boy died during a *dahi handi* celebration in Mumbai on Saturday, Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) officials said. At least 168 people were injured in celebrations across the city. The deceased was identified as Rudra Kadam. The incident occurred around 3 p.m. during a local *dahi handi* celebration at Ekta Welfare Society in Malad (West). The young Govindas, the name used for people celebrating *dahi handi*, were forming human pyramids on Saturday when a brick column to which the curd pot was attached collapsed on the victim causing head injury, according to the BMC.

India votes in favour of UNGA resolution on new world map

India has voted in favour of a UN General Assembly resolution aimed at correcting the world map to promote a “more accurate representation” of continental landmasses. The 193-member UN General Assembly on Friday overwhelmingly adopted the resolution “Correct the map: rebalancing global cartographic representation and promoting equitable representation of the world’s regions, particularly Africa”. The resolution was sponsored by Togo, receiving 164 votes in favour, with abstentions from Estonia, Georgia, Lithuania, Moldova, Serbia and Ukraine, and a lone vote against from the United States.

SC panel issues notice to Punjab govt. on job quota

The National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) on Saturday issued a notice to the Punjab government over a complaint that the reservation policy for Scheduled Castes had been violated in the recruitment of over 1,000 lecturer positions notified by the Punjab Education Department. The complaint was filed by Bharatiya Janata Party MP Tarun Chugh, who alleged that the Aam Aadmi Party-led government in Punjab had failed to implement “the prescribed 25% Scheduled Castes and 12% Backward Classes reservation in the recruitment of 1,013 lecturers”. The NCSC has sought all records related to the allegations within a week.

Manipur body seeks impartial probe into ambush of Thadous

The Thadou Inpi Manipur (TIM), the apex body of the Thadou community in Manipur, has demanded an impartial and time-bound investigation into the killing of three church leaders on May 13, that triggered a chain of abductions and more deaths in the State. The three Thadou Baptist Association India leaders were killed in an ambush in Kangpokpi district. In a statement on Friday, the TIM resented the sloth in the probe despite the Manipur government having handed the case over to the National Investigation Agency (NIA). It urged the agency to clarify the status of the probe, within the limits permitted in an ongoing investigation.

SUDOKU

				4	8			
	3	7		2				4
		8	3				1	7
	8	3						
	1						5	
					6	9		
5	6			2	9			
3					4	7		
			5	3				

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★★

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

5	1	8	9	3	6	2	4	7
2	9	3	7	4	1	8	6	5
4	6	7	8	5	2	3	1	9
8	2	5	3	1	9	4	7	6
6	7	1	5	8	4	9	2	3
9	3	4	2	6	7	5	8	1
1	4	9	6	2	3	7	5	8
7	5	6	4	9	8	1	3	2
3	8	2	1	7	5	6	9	4

Census advanced in four poll-bound States, formally deferred in Manipur

U.P., Punjab, Uttarakhand and Goa to complete population enumeration before elections; in Manipur, the exercise has been deferred amid calls for compiling NRC first; Congress says question on caste will render the whole caste census meaningless

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The Union government on Saturday advanced the Population Enumeration phase of Census 2027 in the poll-bound States of Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Uttarakhand and Goa, scheduling the exercise from November 16, 2026, to January 4, 2027, ahead of the nationwide enumeration planned for February 2027. The government also formally deferred the Census exercise in Manipur “till further declaration.”

The second phase of Census 2027 will have 40 questions and include an open-ended field for recording caste details. Respondents will also have the option of either not disclosing their caste or stating that they do not belong to any caste.

There are at least 13 new questions compared with the 2011 Census. The questions being introduced for



Booth Level Officers distribute enumeration forms to every household for verification during Census exercises. FILE PHOTO

the first time relate to spouse’s name, nationality, father’s particulars and mother’s particulars, digital literacy, permanent residential address, place of Covid-19 vaccination, number of bank accounts, passport number, availability of driving licence and mobile, Aadhaar and voter ID numbers, if available.

According to a notification issued by the Registrar General and Census Com-

missioner of India, under the Census Act, 1948, the enumeration in the four States will be followed by a revisional round from January 5 to January 9, 2027. Residents of these States will have the option of self-enumeration through a dedicated portal between November 16 and November 30, ahead of the door-to-door survey, which will begin December 1.

The government has

fixed 00.00 hours on January 5, 2027, as the reference date for the Census in these States and the region, while for the rest of the country, the said date is March 1. The reference date for Ladakh and the snow-bound areas of Uttarakhand, Jammu and Kashmir and Himachal Pradesh, where the population enumeration is going on, is October 1, 2026.

‘Shoddy planning’

Congress leader Jairam Ramesh said the fresh notification shows “shoddy planning” on the part of the government.

“The population enumeration that was to take place in Feb 2027 as part of the Census 2027 exercise (that was due in 2021) has been advanced in UP, Punjab, Uttarakhand and Goa, where elections are due early next year. This shows shoddy planning since it was known that these elections were due. Why the

sudden dawn of wisdom? Undoubtedly there are some nefarious political calculations afoot,” Mr. Ramesh said.

“Question #10 being asked on caste is deliberately very poorly designed and will render the whole caste census exercise meaningless. The LoP-LS and LoP-RS had written to the PM on Aug 20, 2026 on this issue. Clearly their pleas for mid-course correction... have been totally ignored,” he posted on X.

Meanwhile, another notification was issued for Manipur deferring the Census exercise indefinitely. A large section of civil society groups from the Meitei and Naga communities has demanded that a National Register of Citizens (NRC) be compiled first before the Census exercise is undertaken in the ethnic violence-hit State.

Manipur has three major communities—the Meitei, the tribal Naga and the Kuki-Zo.

NIA files charges against 13 in spying case

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The National Investigation Agency (NIA) has filed a chargesheet against 13 accused persons in an espionage case.

On Saturday, the agency identified them as Praveen, Raj Valmiki, Shiva Valmiki, Ritik Gangwar, Suhel Malik, Sameer, Durgesh Nishad, Naushad, Gagan Kumar, Vivek, Shivraj, Meera Thakur and Shane Iram. In May, it had filed a Detailed Investigation Report against five minors before the Juvenile Justice Board.

The case was initially registered on March 14, 2026 at Ghaziabad. So far, 21 accused persons have been arrested in the case.

According to the agency, the accused illegally trespassed into, approached and accessed prohibited/sensitive areas of vital importance, installed spy cameras, and transmitted sensitive information - including photographs and videos with geo-tagging - to entities based in an “enemy country”.

Former wrestler, two children found dead in Maharashtra fort

Snehal Mutha
MUMBAI

Former national-level wrestler Ashwini Pol, 30, and her two children have been found dead in a 100-foot gorge at the Naldurg fort in Maharashtra’s Dharashiv district.

Her third child, found in a seriously injured condition at the site, is on ventilator support. “A *prima facie* investigation shows that Ashwini was harassed over dowry and mentally tortured for giving birth to twin daughters,” said Ravindra Gaikwad, the investigating officer in the case.

The Dharashiv police have registered a case of abetment of suicide and dowry harassment against Pol’s spouse and in-laws after a complaint was registered by her father, Tanaji Shivaji Mohite. Mr. Mohite, a teacher, is a resident of Whantal in Umarga.

Before the incident, Pol, her six-year-old son, and

Police have booked her spouse and in-laws on suicide abetment and dowry harassment charges

twin daughters had been living at her maternal home.

The incident took place on Thursday. Her surviving daughter is in a critical condition.

The police registered the case against her spouse and in-laws under sections 80 (dowry death), 108 (abetment of suicide) and 85 (cruelty by a husband or his relatives against a woman) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

Pol had won five gold and six silver medals in State- and national-level wrestling competitions.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on Tele-MANAS helpline 14416 and SNEHA number 044 24640050)

NIA court convicts 10 Maoists in 2013 Jheeram Valley massacre case

Shubhomoy Sikdar
RAIPUR

A Special NIA Court in Chhattisgarh’s Jagdalpur has convicted ten Maoists in the 2013 Jheeram Valley massacre in Sukma. At least 27 people, including top Congress leaders from the State, were killed in that Naxal attack.

The ten convicted – Pramila Modiyam, Chaitu Lekam alias Munna, Sumitra alias Sumitra Punem Modiyam, Mukka Mandvi, Kosa Kavasi alias Kosaram, Aayata Markam, Madkami Deva, Joga Madkami, Banjani Anna alias Chamru alias Dengra and Mahadev Nag – are mostly lower-ranked commanders or armed guerillas.

Arvind Choudhary, defence lawyer for the accused, confirmed the conviction and said that the quantum of the punishment would be pronounced by the court on September 16. He added that his clients would ap-



A view of the NIA special court in Jagdalpur which delivered verdict in the 2013 Maoist attack case on Saturday. ANI

peal against the conviction in the High Court.

The case pertains to one of the deadliest Maoist attacks in the country, reported on May 25, 2013, when a large group of Maoists attacked a convoy of Congress leaders, around 10km from the Darbha police station in Sukma district. The convoy was returning from Sukma after holding a Parivartan Yatra rally, a political campaign through which the party was targeting the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party ahead of the As-

sembly polls scheduled later that year.

According to the prosecution, as the convoy came close to the Jheeram Valley, CPI Maoist cadres first triggered a landmine blast, creating a crater on the road. The blast brought the vehicles in the Parivartan Yatra convoy to a halt.

The landmine explosion was followed by indiscriminate firing, grenade attacks and targeted killings, resulting in the death of 24 people and grievous injuries to over 35 others, some of whom died later.

Those killed included the then Chhattisgarh Congress chief Nand Kumar Patel and former Leader of the Opposition Mahendra Karma.

Former Union Minister Vidya Charan Shukla was injured and later succumbed to his injuries.

Mr. Karma was the main target. He was leading Salwa Judum, a State-backed movement against the Maoist insurgency that involved arming local youths. The movement was later declared illegal and unconstitutional by the Supreme Court.

The NIA took over the probe into the case and charged 39 cadres of the banned outfit. Barse Sukka, alias Deva – a top-ranked commander who surrendered before the Telangana Police in January this year – was then in charge of the Darbha Divisional Committee and was appointed the commander to carry out the attack, said investigators.

Climate scientist Krishna AchutaRao passes away

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

Krishna AchutaRao, a leading voice in climate and atmospheric sciences and professor at the Centre for Atmospheric Sciences, Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi, died on Friday. He was 62.

Among his key contributions were determining the degree to which observed climatic change could be attributed to human activity. Over the years, his collaborative work with several scientists demonstrated detectable human influence on temperature changes across Indian sub-regions. This played a key role in connecting global climate science with the regional risks confronting India.

“Krishna was a long-time friend and colleague, and we had many conversations and arguments about climate science. He



Krishna AchutaRao

was also a clear and principled critic whenever scientific temper was compromised, something that has become increasingly important in the present political climate,” Roxy Mathew Koll, climate scientist at the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology, Pune, told *The Hindu*. He added, “...for many of us it is also the loss of a warm, thoughtful friend with a wonderful sense of humour. I will miss him deeply.”

In his two decades at IIT

Delhi, he served as Head of the Centre for Atmospheric Sciences and Dean (Faculty), helping establish the institute’s Centre of Excellence for Climate Change Adaptation. An engineering graduate, he worked at Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory’s Program for Climate Model Diagnosis and Intercomparison in the U.S., before returning to India in 2007. “Krishna was a wonderful person and, of late, worked on the attribution of climate events like heat waves. He also applied AI tools in climate change and monsoon research. We will miss him,” Madhavan Rajeevan, Vice-Chancellor, ATRIA University, and former Secretary, Ministry of Earth Sciences, told *The Hindu*.

AchutaRao was also a member of the World Climate Research Programme’s Joint Scientific Committee from 2025.

Probe on into ‘counterfeit’ rabies vaccine, says CDSCO

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

The Central Drugs Laboratory (CDL) in Kasauli, Himachal Pradesh, has flagged a batch of Abhayrab vaccine, used against rabies, “not of standard quality” and “misbranded” after it failed a potency test, raising concerns of circulation of counterfeits and prompting a probe.

The vaccine samples, bearing batch number KE25012, were seized on April 22 during an enforcement action by the Delhi Police and officials of Delhi’s Drugs Control Department from an “unlicensed residential premises”. They were found to differ from genuine reference samples in packaging, labelling, artwork, QR-code verification, cap colour, and licence details.

Four persons have been arrested by the Delhi Police in connection with the

incident so far and further investigation and appropriate legal action are being undertaken by the competent authorities, the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) said in a statement on Saturday.

The investigation will now have to establish who manufactured the suspect KE25012 vials and whether any patients received them. While it is yet to confirm whether the misbranded vaccines entered circulation in the country, the CDSCO said that no part of the batch concerned was exported to any other country.

The Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI), in a communication dated August 27, has requested all State Drugs Controllers to maintain strict vigilance over the movement, distribution, and availability batch KE25012 of Abhayrab, the CDSCO said.

Indian Immunologicals Ltd. (IIL), which manufactures Abhayrab through its Human Biologicals Institute (HBI), has said that the concerned vaccines bearing batch number KE25012 were not produced by the company.

In a statement issued on Friday, IIL said the genuine KE25012 batch had undergone the required testing and was released on November 7, 2025. The company said the batch comprised 83,370 vials and was distributed through its authorised network.

The development follows an earlier counterfeit Abhayrab episode involving batch KA24014 in 2025. IIL had reported suspected counterfeit vials to authorities, following which health warnings were issued in some countries over the possibility that travellers to India could have received counterfeit rabies vaccine.

INBRIEF



Govt. rejects ‘no takers’ charge for coal gasification scheme

The Ministry of Coal rejected reports that the Centre’s coal gasification incentive scheme failed to attract applicants, saying Talcher Fertilisers Ltd. (TFL) and NTPC Ltd. have already submitted applications ahead of the September 7 deadline. “Based on discussions with stakeholders, the Ministry has been informed that TFL and NTPC Ltd. have already submitted their respective applications through the online portal. This itself demonstrates that the assertion that the scheme has received ‘no takers’ is factually incorrect,” the ministry said in a statement. The Ministry said several other prospective applicants are also in communication with it, with their projects at various stages of preparation and application finalisation. The request for proposal (RfP) was subsequently issued, with the current application window closing on September 7.

Tata Motors unveils tender for Iveco’s common shares

Iveco Group N.V., an international leader in commercial vehicles and mobility and Tata Motors Ltd., a global automotive leader, jointly announced the commencement of voluntary tender offer by TML CV Holdings B.V. for all issued common shares of Iveco Group at a price of €14.1 (cum dividend) per common share in cash. This follows the approval for the offer from the Italian market regulator. The offer has been made by a Tata Motors step down subsidiary. The acceptance period runs from September 7 to October 26. “The Iveco Group board of directors unanimously supports the Transaction, recommends the Offer for acceptance by the shareholders of Iveco Group and recommends Shareholders to vote in favour of the resolutions relating to the Offer at the EGM,” Tata Motors said in a filing. Iveco Group will hold the EGM on October 16 to secure shareholders’ approval.

Now, small-town millennials dipping into cryptos via SIPs

From the thrill of overnight riches that drove the crypto craze in 2021, investors in India are maturing in the way they invest and a new tool that reflects this maturity is the crypto SIP

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The crypto sector in India is going through a transformation, with the get-rich-quick impulse of the young investors five years ago increasingly giving way to a more mature, systematic, and long-term attitude towards crypto investments. And this change can best be seen in the rise of a new type of crypto product: crypto Systematic Investment Plans (SIPs).

The crypto space in India is still unregulated and so finding official industry-wide data is impossible. However, some of the of the largest crypto exchanges *The Hindu* has spoken reported rapid growth in crypto SIPs.

As per calculations based on government data, more than ₹51,000 crore crypto investments took place in India in 2024-25, the latest year for which there is data. By all accounts, an increasing share is being routed through the SIP route.

Further, most of the crypto SIPs’ activity is coming from Tier-II and Tier-III cities and as one crypto exchange put it, even from “Tier 10 cities”.

Rapid growth
As per CoinDCX, about 20% people that were earlier investing in a single crypto asset such as Bitcoin are now choosing



The paradox: India’s regulatory bodies, however, remain less-than-keen to enter the crypto space. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

crypto SIPs. This share was just 2-3% or maximum 4%, as recently as nine months ago,” said Mridul Gupta, founding partner, CoinDCX.

He pointed out how the present cohort of crypto investors choosing crypto SIPs is qualitatively different from five years ago.

“Now, we see a lot of disciplined investment from a more mature audience now versus a GenZ kind of an audience,” he added. “In the last 3-6 months, our daily SIP creation at an absolute level has also gone up by 50-60%. It’s increasing at that pace every quarter or so.”

According to Prateek Gupta, head of business at Mudrex, over the last 12-18 months, the company has seen the Assets Under Management (AUM) via SIP route grow almost 220% or nearly 3x.

Balaji Srihari, vice-president of the India Business

at CoinSwitch also attested to the rapid growth in the SIP category.

“Between 2023-24 and 2025-26, active SIP users grew by about 75%, while the number of active SIPs increased by about 93%,” Mr. Srihari said. “

Long-term thinking

“This SIP trend has been so great in India in general,” Mr. Gupta of CoinDCX said. “People don’t want to time when they are investing. They want to hedge the risk and be consistent and more disciplined in their investments.”

The way this works, Mr. Gupta from Mudrex explained, is a little different from how a normal auto-pay works in a mutual fund.

For example, a user can deposit a bulk amount of ₹1 lakh on any crypto platform and set up a monthly SIP of ₹10,000 that will be debited from that amount

every month. The corresponding crypto asset bought each month will be deposited in the user’s wallet each month.

So, users will also benefit from any price increase that happens over this period.

Past youth, metros

According to CoinSwitch, the 26-35 years age group forms the largest segment of crypto SIP users, accounting for roughly 42-44% of users. Those aged 36-45 account for about 28-31% followed by 18-25 year group at about 14-16%. Users aged 46 and above represent roughly 12-13%.

“You would be surprised by the kind of cities that we see a lot of participation from,” Mr. Gupta of Mudrex said. “They are not even like Tier 2, they are Tier 10!”

For regulators

India’s regulatory bodies, however, remain less-than-keen to enter the crypto space.

“We have been looking at crypto and the changes happening, but until the government decides whether it wants to classify cryptos as currencies or assets, there is little that we can do on this,” a senior Securities and Exchange Board of India official told *The Hindu*. Reserve Bank of India officials also said they have not changed stance on private cryptos and their use in India.

‘U.S. LPG is not a silver bullet for India’

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

India’s move to diversify LPG procurement by sourcing more supplies from the U.S. may not be the silver bullet that helps it weather the current crisis despite the U.S. being a major LPG producer and expanding its export terminal capacity, James Rockall, CEO and MD, World Liquid Gas Association (WLGA), told *The Hindu*.

Separately, he said India should also focus on expanding LPG storage capacity and managing freight costs to boost its position in the global market.

Diversification vital

Mr. Rockall emphasised diversifying sources was imperative for India to respond to West Asia supply crisis, with the U.S. emerging as an “obvious choice”.

India now sources 67% of LPG imports from the U.S., Union Oil Minister Hardeep Puri had said.

“The obvious choice was the U.S. as they are a big producer, a growing producer and are investing in export terminals,” Mr. Rockall said. However, he cautioned, “It is not the magic solution that is going to lead you out of the crisis as India is not alone in trying to procure from the U.S. It already has a lot of its product tied up in term deals,” he said.

“Getting access to that product in the short term is never going to be easy, but I have been very impressed with the way India has responded to this proactively,” he said.

He also pointed to other



James Rockall

potential sources of LPG that India could explore, including Canada, Algeria, Argentina, Australia and West Africa.

Shipping, storage

He also said Indian refiners should actively manage freight costs to take advantage of lower free-on-board prices when they arise.

“[These could be either through] looking at short-term charters, working with shipping fleets, owning vessels or whatever,” he said. Such strategies “would allow Indian companies to capture the shipping economics themselves rather than leave them to suppliers and gives guarantee of availability.”

This would also help Indian oil marketing companies avoid competing in the open freight market where premiums have risen amid West Asia issue

India must expand LPG storage capacity to better manage market volatility.

“Having storage gives you a little bit more time to fix the issues. I think greater storage is something India should look at to manage the volatility of the market,” he said.

When pets become premium customers, get insurance cover

Amarnath K.

Bella gives the bowl a doubtful look. She takes a hesitant sniff of the pedigree food “served” before her and tosses it aside with immense disapproval.

For Tanvi, a journalist, this has become a familiar routine. Her Persian cat, Bella, refuses regular pedigree cat food and waits impatiently for the more expensive fare to arrive in her bowl—the one that, apparently, smells right.

Bella’s preference reflects a broader shift taking place in the pet-care market where owners are increasingly willing to pay a premium for products they believe are better suited for the pets.

“A few years ago, expensive pedigree food like Royal Canin was a rarity,” says Renjith K.J., an amateur dog breeder. Today, however, premium brands such as Royal Canin have become increasingly common in pet stores, reflecting a growing appetite for high-end pet products.

The transformation accelerated during the COVID-19 when pet ownership and spending on pets surged. A story published in *The Hindu* on July 25, 2026, highlighted how the pet industry boomed during COVID-19 and underwent significant changes in the years that followed.

One of the most visible changes was premiumisation of pet care. What was once considered optional or indulgent expense is increasingly being treated as an essential part of pet ownership.

Pet insurance offers another example of the changing consumer mindset. Once an unfamiliar concept in India, pet insu-



Part of family: Pet cover is gradually gaining attention as owners begin to view veterinary care as responsible pet ownership. AFP

rance is gradually gaining attention as owners begin to view veterinary care and financial protection as part of responsible pet ownership.

As per data from IMARC, global pet-care products market touched \$48.6 billion in 2025 and is projected to grow at a compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of 5.24% in 2026-34.

Medical expenditure

Dr. Soorej K., founder of Cochin Pet Hospital, Kerala’s first private multi-speciality veterinary hospital, says the changing culture of pet ownership has significantly influenced attitudes towards pet care.

“Pet parents nowadays consider pets as family members,” he says.

This has created a demand for more advanced and specialised treatment that often costs more.

“Expensive treatments like haemodialysis, laparoscopic surgery, keyhole animal birth control, etc., are offered to pets like dogs and cats. Pet parents specifically ask for these novel methods of healthcare,” Dr. Soorej says.

Healthcare for pets has become an increasingly expensive affair. Aswathi, a

like veterinary hospitals, kennel clubs and pet shows.

Hospitals as a channel

Veterinary hospitals are increasingly becoming an important channel for spreading awareness about pet insurance. Dr. Soorej’s hospital is among those encouraging pet parents to consider insurance as the cost of ownership and medical treatment is rising.

“A premium that starts with just ₹1,700 annually saves a lot of money that the pet parents don’t realise they spend,” he said.

Is it practical?

According to research by IMARC, India’s pet insurance market generated a revenue of \$331.1 million in 2025. The market is projected to show a CAGR of 12.6% between 2026 and 2034, reaching an estimated \$993.4 million by 2034.

Lack of documentation

Dr. R. Jayaprakash, founder of J.P. Pet Speciality Hospital, says the absence of proper documentation at many veterinary hospitals makes the process particularly difficult.

Also, many hospitals are reluctant to process cashless claims because reimbursements can take months or even years.

Such limitations leave pet owners with little incentive to buy insurance, a situation that is equally discouraging for insurance agents looking to promote policies via veterinary hospitals, Dr. Jayaprakash adds.

“I have asked insurance agents to simplify criteria, which would encourage pet owners to buy policies,” he says.

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What is 'One Nation, One Time'?

Why is BRICS exploring cross-border payments?

Why is the Centre opposed to totalisers?

PROFILES

The house of multilaterals

Shanghai Cooperation Organisation

At the Bishkek Summit, member countries, including India, have condemned the military strikes on Iran, reaffirmed ‘support for its sovereignty and territorial integrity’, and criticised the U.S. and Israel for violating the principles of international law and the UN Charter

Kallol Bhattacharjee

The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) held its 26th summit at Kyrgyz Republic’s capital Bishkek on August 31-September 1, which was attended by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Russian President Vladimir Putin, Chinese President Xi Jinping, Iran’s President Masoud Pezeshkian and other leaders of the member countries. The summit marked the completion of 25 years of the organisation that was launched on June 15, 2001 with China, Russia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyz Republic and Tajikistan – the Shanghai five – as its founding members. India and Pakistan joined the group in 2017.

The Bishkek meet was the first summit of the grouping since the U.S. and Israel started their war on Iran on February 28, 2026, killing the country’s Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei and a host of other senior officials. The Bishkek Declaration expressed “deep concern”, and condemned military strikes on Iran, reaffirmed “support for its sovereignty and territorial integrity”, and criticised the U.S. and Israel for violating the principles of international law and the UN Charter.

They also condoned the assassination of Ali Khamenei and welcomed the peace process that is being supported and mediated by multiple countries, including SCO member Pakistan. In an indirect support for Iran in its nuclear negotiations with the U.S., the SCO summit advocated “inalienable right” of the member countries to “develop” “atomic energy for peaceful purposes”.

The declaration also asserted that the only way to ensure lasting stability in the West Asian region is through a just settlement of the Palestine question. Member states maintained silence on Russia’s role in the Ukraine war and added that “unilateral and unlimited build-up of global missile defence systems by groups of states” has a “negative impact on international security and stability”.

The declaration also mentioned that “unauthorised satellite Internet



services on the territory of Member States” is a violation of international law – an obvious reference to entrepreneur Elon Musk’s Starlink providing Internet services in parts of Eastern Ukraine and Iran.

Indian delegation

Prime Minister Modi led the Indian delegation at the summit where he spoke about ensuring that there is “no double standards” in fighting terrorism and called for peace and stability in Afghanistan. He highlighted India’s role in ensuring supply of relief materials to Taliban-controlled Afghanistan over the years, and spoke in favour of greater connectivity between the markets of the SCO members while respecting sovereignty and territorial integrity of the states.

The declaration also called on Afghanistan to form an “inclusive government”. Mr. Modi’s mention of connectivity while respecting territorial integrity is an apparent reference to the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) that has been a target of India’s criticism over the years. This factor indicated a bit of dissonance within the grouping as India stayed away from endorsing the

China-led BRI but other member states expressed support and also advocated alignment between the BRI and the Eurasian Economic Union.

Mr. Modi’s focus on terrorism at the Bishkek summit highlighted an uncomfortable issue India will have to deal with over the next year. With the conclusion of the summit, Pakistan has assumed the chair of the SCO, and the group’s next summit will be held in that country.

The Ministry of External Affairs has not yet clarified whether Mr. Modi will travel to Pakistan to attend the SCO summit next year. External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar had visited Islamabad in 2024 to attend the 23rd meeting of the SCO Council of Heads of Government. The Pahalgam terror attack of April 22, 2025, the subsequent Operation Sindoor, and India’s decision to place the Indus Waters Treaty ‘in abeyance’ have further complicated India-Pakistan relations. These developments will be a factor in New Delhi’s decision on the level at which the government sends representatives to next year’s summit in Pakistan.

The Bishkek Declaration included strong language on the troika of

challenges – “terrorism, separatism and extremism” – and “strongly condemned” terrorism, reflecting India’s concerns as well as those of other members.

The SCO, which includes both Russia and Iran as members, provides a unique platform for the two countries to articulate their positions on the wars. It allows the primary actors in these conflicts to explain their objectives and positions in a multilateral setting. The SCO also gives the world an opportunity to engage China multilaterally, particularly on issues such as freedom of navigation in the South China Sea.

A platform for engagement

It also provides India and Pakistan with a platform for sustained engagement within a broader multilateral framework. Such engagement is important for regional stability and can help prevent bilateral hostilities from spilling over. The SCO does not have a collective defence component and several of its members have differences and disputes with one another – for example, India-Pakistan tensions and India-China border problem – yet, the grouping has

managed to survive for 25 years.

The grouping has 29 charter bodies like the Council of Heads of State, the Council of Heads of Government, the Council of Ministers of Foreign Affairs, meetings of heads of ministries and/or agencies, the Council of National Coordinators, as well as over 40 working mechanisms of interaction in various fields.

These charter bodies meet throughout the year and serve as formal channels of communication on issues of concern to member states. In the event of a sudden conflict or a cross-border natural calamity, such frequent consultations can serve a practical purpose. The SCO also exerts some pressure on the Trump-era world order. Its leaders have periodically called for greater use of local currencies in trade, a practice viewed with scepticism in the West, particularly by the current U.S. leadership. The announcement of the establishment of an SCO Development Bank is another step in this direction.

Diplomatic objectives

India has used the SCO to advance its diplomatic objectives on multiple occasions since joining the grouping in 2017. Two relevant examples are the 2025 Tianjin Summit and the 2024 Kazan Summit. Seeking to rebuild ties after the setback at Galwan, India and China began to reengage at the Kazan Summit in Russia, where Mr. Modi met Chinese President Xi Jinping.

This was followed by another meeting between the two leaders in Tianjin where they agreed on an ‘Early Harvest’ proposal on boundary delimitation and resumption of border trade through three points. The Tianjin meeting demonstrated that the two sides retained the political will to meet despite the strain in ties following Operation Sindoor in May 2025, when China provided support to Pakistan as India targeted terror camps in Pakistani territory.

It also showed that, amid an uncertain phase in India-U.S. relations, with President Donald Trump imposing punitive tariffs on Indian goods, New Delhi could engage all major stakeholders and maintain necessary diplomatic dialogue.

THE GIST

The Bishkek Summit marked the completion of 25 years of the SCO that was launched on June 15, 2001 with China, Russia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyz Republic and Tajikistan – the Shanghai five – as the original members. India and Pakistan became members of the group in 2017

Prime Minister Modi led the Indian delegation at the summit where he spoke about ensuring “no double standards” in fighting terrorism and called for peace and stability in Afghanistan

The Bishkek Declaration included strong language on the troika of challenges – “terrorism, separatism and extremism” – and “strongly condemned” terrorism, reflecting India’s concerns

Power beyond the pulpit

Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker

The Muslim cleric and scholar based in Keralam has faced criticism over his recent comments that women should remain at home rather than occupy public spaces

Abdul Latheef Naha

Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar, the Grand Mufti of India, has been a leading figure in Keralam’s traditional Sunni Muslim community for more than five decades. Not a stranger to controversies, Kanthapuram, as he is popularly known, recently hogged the headlines for jointly issuing a circular to mahallus in his capacity as general secretary of the Samstha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama, asking them “not to exhibit women in front of other men on the streets or stages” during Islamic celebrations.

Issued in the context of the Milad festivities, the circular courted controversy, following which Kanthapuram said bringing women to public forums would cause serious “chaos” and that Islam prescribed purdah for women to prevent this. The comments triggered sharp criticism from different sections and leaders, including from Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan, who said the cleric’s comments were unsuitable for modern, progressive Keralam. The CPI(M), his long-term ally, too, sharply attacked the decree.

But that controversy is only one part of the story of a scholar whose influence extends across In-



dia and to Muslim communities abroad. Kanthapuram, Ustad in Keralam, is known as Sheikh Abubakr Ahmad in the wider Muslim world. He is the founder of Jamia Markaz at Karanthur near Kozhikode, around which he has built a large religious, educational and social network.

At 89, he continues to teach the Hadith collection regarded by Muslims as the most authentic collection of reports on Prophet Muhammad’s teachings and practices.

Kanthapuram’s rise began within the Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama, the traditional body of Islamic scholars in Keralam. He was one of its prominent secretaries under Shamsul Ulama E.K. Aboobacker Musliar. In 1989, differences over the influence of the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) led to a split. Kanthapuram and his followers walked out and formed a separate organisation. The division conti-

nues, leaving Keralam’s traditional Sunni community broadly divided between the E.K. and A.P. factions. He built his organisation around Markazu Saquafathi Sunniyya, founded at Karanthur in 1978.

His project Markaz Knowledge City near Kozhikode became controversial after a strand of hair claimed to belong to Prophet Muhammad was brought there. His followers regard it as a sacred relic; critics have questioned its authenticity. CPI(M) leader Pinarayi Vijayan famously called it “body waste”. Kanthapuram has repeatedly faced criticism over his conservative views on women.

Political influence

His political influence grew after the 1989 split, when his group developed close ties with the CPI(M)-led establishment in Keralam. Yet Kanthapuram has maintained relations across party lines. Leaders

of the Congress, the IUML, the CPI(M) and the BJP have met him. Prime Minister Narendra Modi has met him several times.

His reach extends well beyond politics. He was associated with the Amman Message and A Common Word, international initiatives promoting Islamic unity and Muslim-Christian understanding.

He has used these networks for humanitarian causes. In 2025, he intervened in the case of Kerala nurse Nimisha Priya, who was facing execution in Yemen, and saved her from the gallows through contacts with influential Yemeni religious figures.

The disappearance of Islamic reformist Chekannur Moulavi in 1993 remains a difficult chapter. Kanthapuram was questioned by the CBI but was not made an accused. The Kerala High Court later rejected a petition seeking to arraign him for lack of sufficient evidence.

Few religious leaders in Keralam have remained so influential for so long. From a young scholar in Kozhikode to the head of an international network, Kanthapuram’s influence extends far beyond Karanthur. To his followers, he is a scholar, teacher and institution-builder; to his critics, a conservative cleric with deep influence over public and political life.

An icon of modern warfare

Javelin

The anti-tank system India is planning to acquire is a mainstay brigade combat team weapon for the U.S. Army and Marine Corps

Murali N. Krishnaswamy

Big news! India plans to buy the battle-tested Javelin anti-tank system”, U.S. Ambassador to India Sergio Gor posted on X on August 28. This is “a great step forward in the U.S.-India defense relationship, opening the door to co-production possibilities”, he wrote. The significance of the announcement lies not merely in the planned purchase, but in what the Javelin brings to India’s defence arsenal.

Developed and made by the Javelin Joint Venture (JJV) between Raytheon and Lockheed Martin, the Javelin has been described as a versatile, portable and multi-purpose weapon system that can handle a spectrum of threats. More precisely, it is a ‘fire-and-forget’ anti-tank guided missile (ATGM) system that comprises a Command Launch Unit (CLU) and the missile. The CLU has the day/night sighting system, the electronics and the controls while the missile’s imaging infrared seeker guides it after the launch. Locking onto its target before launch, it allows the operator to move away after firing.

A peek into the company’s production literature uncovers the following list: with over 20 years of performance, the Javelin has



been in action in operations across a range of theatres. After classroom training of only 72 hours, a soldier can take advantage of the missile’s ‘low-signature’ launch (or minimal detectability) to carry out a variety of attack modes; these range from top-attack targets such as tanks to direct-attack capability for caves, bunkers or soft targets.

Operational readiness

And, with an operational readiness rate of 99% and an engagement success rate of 94%, the armament has established itself as a mainstay brigade combat team weapon for the U.S. Army and U.S. Marine Corps. It is expected to be in the U.S. military’s operational inventory until 2050. The company has also highlighted its economic impact, covering 63 domestic suppliers in 18 states and 22 international suppliers. But it is one point that stands out: the detail of “5,000 combat fir-

ings (Prior to Ukraine)”.

In service since 1996, the Javelin has been used in the invasion of Iraq in 2003 and also in Afghanistan. Yet, it is in Ukraine that the Javelin acquired its reputation as a weapon that could take on Russian might. The Javelin also has an interesting imagery. In a 2022 article, journalist Matthew Gault, who writes on conflict and culture, highlighted the popularity of “St. Javelin, a symbol of the conflict in Ukraine”. Surrounded by a bright red halo and the golden trident coat-of-arms of Ukraine, this creation of ‘meme-mythology’, clad in green robes, carries an FGM-148 Javelin anti-tank missile launcher in her arms, portraying a defiant symbol of resistance.

For India, the nitty-gritty of the August 2026 announcement lies in the proposed assembly of the ATGMs; in the memorandum of understanding between JJV and Tata Advanced Systems Ltd

(TASL), Javelin All Up Rounds (AURs) are to be co-produced domestically. Much of the component production would be in the U.S. where the Lockheed Martin plant in Alabama will produce the Javelin’s “sub-assembly kits”, while Raytheon’s facility in Arizona will manufacture its “guidance electronics units”. Both systems will then be shipped to TASL for final assembly and incorporation into the ATGM. In essence, the U.S. will hold the reins.

The development also marks the difficulty that India has faced in overcoming a hurdle: it has taken it over 15 years to resolve differences with the U.S. over technology transfer and local production. During this time, India has maintained a diverse anti-tank inventory, including limited supplies of the Israeli Spike, while pursuing the Defence Research and Development Organisation’s ‘Third Generation’ Fire and Forget Man Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile.

However, to a few established defence commentators, such as Rahul Bedi, the subtext of Mr. Gor’s “big news” is the path that India has chosen for its anti-tank missile programme – either as a looming shadow over its indigenous missile efforts or a pragmatic response to a pressing military requirement.

LONDON
U.K. slams masked anti-immigrant protesters who blocked Dover port



Dozens of masked anti-immigration protesters blocked roads leading to Britain's Port of Dover on Saturday, disrupting travellers and cargo vehicles heading for France. The government condemned the action, saying it went beyond peaceful protest. The National Highways agency said the protest caused a 6.4-km traffic jam. AP

JAKARTA
Nearly 2,000 fall ill in suspected Indonesia food poisoning outbreak



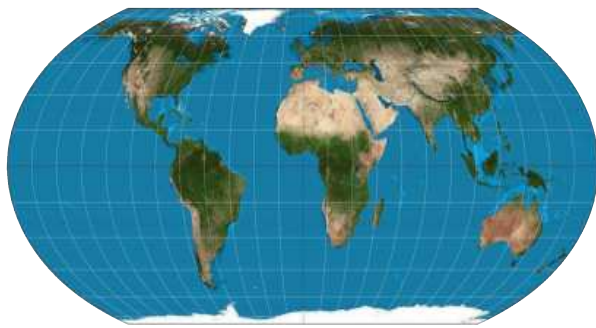
Nearly 2,000 people, most of them students, fell ill in suspected food poisoning outbreaks linked to President Prabowo Subianto's flagship Free Nutritious Meals programme this week, raising fresh concerns about food safety as the government rapidly expands the multibillion-dollar initiative, officials said on Saturday. AP

TURMUS AYYA
Israeli govt. bore responsibility for West Bank Palestinians: U.S. envoy



The U.S. Ambassador to Israel Mike Huckabee said on Saturday that the Israeli government bore responsibility for West Bank Palestinians' safety and should impose "severe consequences" over violence, as he visited families after a surge in settler attacks. Mr. Huckabee is long known as a staunch supporter of Israel. AFP

NEW YORK
UN General Assembly endorses using Equal Earth projection map



The United Nations General Assembly on Friday endorsed a new world map that represents Africa more accurately in its larger size. The resolution encourages governments and institutions around the world to replace the traditional Mercator map with the Equal Earth projection that "shows locations more accurately". AP

U.S. military hits 3 Iranian tankers after saying 2 Navy ships targeted

The U.S. describes the tankers as part of a shadow fleet used to fund the IRGC and its regional proxies; 'we will not hesitate to defend American forces, and if necessary, destroy Iran's limited and exposed oil fleet,' says head of U.S. Central Command

Associated Press
CAIRO

U.S. forces struck three Iranian oil tankers after Navy warships were targeted with missiles, the American military said on Saturday, warning that it would "if necessary, destroy Iran's limited and exposed oil fleet".

The strikes – a day after U.S. President Donald Trump sought to minimise the conflict as "small potatoes" – keep up a new tilt back toward fighting after six months of on-again, off-again war that began with U.S. and Israeli attacks on the country on February 28. Both sides have sought



Critical hit: U.S. military forces reportedly striking an Iranian crude oil tanker off the coast of Kharg Island on Saturday. AFP

to inflict both military and economic pain, and negotiations have collapsed.

The military's statement said that an American aircraft carrier and a destroyer evaded "multiple

unprovoked Iranian attacks" while patrolling in the region and no U.S. personnel were hurt. It said that two Iranian oil carriers were "permanently disabled" and the third,

unladen one, was destroyed.

The U.S. statement said that the tankers were part of a shadow network helping to fund Iran's powerful Revolutionary Guard and its armed proxies in the region. There was no immediate Iranian response.

Repeatedly targeted

Earlier, Iranian state television had said that four U.S. missiles struck a tanker about 10 km from Kharg Island, home to a terminal through which the country exports most of its oil. Kharg Island has been repeatedly targeted during the war, including U.S. strikes on military sites there in March.

The U.S. said that one tanker was struck off Kharg Island and another was struck near Jask, east of the Strait of Hormuz. The unladen tanker was hit in the Gulf of Oman, and the U.S. said its crew had been "directed to abandon ship". The statement shared what it called video footage of the strikes.

After the U.S. statement, Iran's state broadcaster reported the two other tankers attacked, saying their crews had evacuated.

"We will not hesitate to defend American forces, and if necessary, destroy Iran's limited and exposed oil fleet," said Admiral Brad Cooper, the head of U.S. Central Command.

Putin orders a 72-hour pause in strikes on Kyiv

Associated Press
MOSCOW

Russian President Vladimir Putin ordered a 72-hour pause in strikes on Kyiv, the Kremlin said on Saturday, as U.S. envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner arrived in Moscow to try to revive a stalled push to end Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine.

"Putin has ordered that no strikes be carried out against Kyiv for three days, starting at midnight today," presidential spokesperson Dmitry Peskov told Russia's Tass news agency. He said the decision was tied to preparations for Mr. Witkoff and Mr. Kushner's planned visit to the Ukrainian capital, which Kyiv has said will take place on Sunday.

Later on Saturday, Mr. Putin met with Mr. Witkoff



Russian envoy Kirill Dmitriev walks with U.S. envoys Jared Kushner and Steve Witkoff upon their arrival in Moscow on Saturday. REUTERS

and Mr. Kushner at the Kremlin, where the Russian President described the situation in Ukraine as "not simple".

The envoys' trip comes as both sides escalate aerial attacks, some four-and-a-half years after the Kremlin's invasion of its neighbour. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Friday that Ukraine

would halt strikes during the envoys' visit and urged Moscow to do the same.

Washington's push to end the fighting, now in its fifth year, has lost momentum as U.S. attention has been focused for the past six months on its war with Iran. The last known visit to Moscow by Mr. Witkoff and Mr. Kushner was in January.

Opposition in Dhaka launches protest rally over energy crisis

Agence France-Presse
DHAKA

Thousands of Opposition supporters launched a long march across Bangladesh on Saturday, piling pressure on Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's government over acute shortages of cooking gas, electricity, and fertilizer.

The action marks the first major street mobilisation against the government which came to power six months ago.

Waving banners and

chanting slogans, crowds gathered in Dhaka before setting off on the first leg of a march to the port city of Chittagong, with rallies planned along the route.

"This movement is aimed at ensuring cooking gas and lighting up every household with electricity," Opposition leader Shafigur Rahman said.

Bangladesh has been reeling from acute shortages while questions have been raised over the government's handling of the crisis.

Rescuers in Nepal pull two people alive from debris 10 days after deadly floods

Associated Press
KATHMANDU

Rescuers in Nepal pulled out a Chinese man and a woman in separate operations on Saturday, 10 days after devastating floods hit the country, as teams continued searching for thousands of missing people.

The man was rescued from a hydropower tunnel, according to a social media post by the country's Prime Minister's office, bringing the total to three workers pulled alive from the Trishuli hydropower project. Two Nepalese



Back to life: Nepalese Army personnel rescue a Chinese national from a hydropower tunnel in Rasuwa district on Saturday. PTI

workers were rescued on Friday.

Nepal's Army said a joint rescue team of Nepalese military personnel

and South Korean disaster experts rescued the man from a 225-metre tunnel and that he was undergoing a health assessment.

Rescue efforts have increasingly focused on 12 hydropower projects across Nepal, where about 900 workers are missing and roughly 500 are believed to be trapped in various tunnels, authorities said. Specialised rescue teams from India, China, South Korea and the U.S. have been searching through debris, damaged structures and tunnels at the projects, hoping to find survivors.

In flood-hit Nuwakot town, a woman was rescued alive from a house on Saturday.

60 killed in clashes between Houthis, Yemen govt. forces

Agence France-Presse
DUBAI

Fighting between Yemen's Saudi-backed government forces and the country's Houthi rebels killed more than 60 people on Saturday, including civilians, medical and military sources said.

The renewed clashes in Yemen's southwest over control of a gateway to the Red Sea came after Friday saw some of the deadliest fighting in years, following the collapse in July of a

2022 ceasefire.

According to three Yemeni military sources, 26 government troops were killed during several hours of fighting in the country's southwest, while medical and military sources from the Iran-backed Houthis said 31 rebel fighters were killed.

One medical source Taiz said a missile strike also killed six civilians and wounded seven others.

A government official blamed the killing of civilians on the Houthis.

Sport

Satwik-Chirag a step away from China Masters title

BADMINTON

Press Trust of India
SHENZHEN

The Indian men's doubles pair of Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty produced a tactically astute performance to overcome Malaysia's Nur Mohd Azriyn Ayub and Tan Wee Kiong and reach the China Masters final for the third time here on Saturday.

The World No. 5 combination of Satwiksairaj and Chirag, who finished runner-up in the 2023 and 2025 editions, recovered from a second-game lapse to prevail 21-16, 18-21, 21-11 over the World No. 29 duo. They will meet China's He Ji Ting and Ren Xiang



Raising the bar: Chirag, right, stepped up after the Indians suffered a blip in the second game. BADMINTON PHOTO

Yu in the summit clash.

In the deciding game, Satwiksairaj and Chirag put the slip-up behind them, with the latter sharp in finding gaps and cramping the Malaysians for space. A fine moment of

sportsmanship was on display when Chirag apologised and high-fived Tan after a shot came off the frame of his racket.

The Indians converted their third match-point opportunity to advance.

Sable believes he is back to his best

ATHLETICS

Ashwin Achal
BENGALURU

A nasty fall at the Monaco Diamond League last year could not have come at a worse time for Avinash Sable.

Sable had entered the big ticket event in great form, having won the 3,000m steeplechase gold at the Asian championships. He felt supremely fit, and was keen to record his personal best at Monaco.

A stumble on the water jump, however, ended the dream. Sable had to undergo a surgery to fix an ACL and meniscus injury, forcing a hiatus of over a year.

In a media interaction facilitated by the Sports Authority of India here, Sable stated that the 14-



Upbeat: Sable is confident of retaining his Asian Games steeplechase gold. K. MURALI KUMAR

month layoff was marked by self-doubt and emotional turmoil.

There is also a story of redemption as Sable – now fully fit – is set to return to action at the Indian Athletics Series Final to be held in New Delhi next Thursday.

This will act as the ideal

tune-up for the Asian Games, which commences later this month.

Speaking about the ill-fated moment at Monaco, Sable said, "I initially did not think it was a serious injury. It was only after I came back to India did I realise that it was quite bad. I had to miss the

World championships. The last year has been very difficult for me."

The long road to recovery began with light jogging a few months after his surgery.

He stepped up the intensity in April in an effort to make the Glasgow Commonwealth Games, but pain in his shin forced him to withdraw.

Plenty of rehabilitation work later, the 31-year-old believes that he is now back to his best. He is confident he can successfully defend his Asian Games gold medal.

"At one time, I thought that I will have to leave the sport. But now I have the opportunity to come back to the track. I want to give my best to my country and those who supported me in this journey," Sable added.

Forlan names provisional squad for India friendly

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

Uruguay coach Diego Forlan has named a 46-man provisional squad for the team's Asia tour in September-October, which includes a friendly against India at the Salt Lake Stadium on October 6.

The squad, announced by the Uruguayan Football Association, includes 21 players from the 26-member squad picked for the recent World Cup. Real Madrid midfielder Federico Valverde, Ronald Araujo, Rodrigo Bentancur and Darwin Nunez are among the star names. Veteran striker Luis Suarez, however, did not find a place.

INBRIEF



NEUFC unveils jersey for the upcoming ISL season

NorthEast United FC, in partnership with Reebok, unveiled its jersey for the upcoming Indian Super League season in Mumbai on Saturday. NEUFC players and members of the top management, including co-owner John Abraham and CEO Mandar Tamhane, were present along with Aryaman Vikram Birla, director of the Aditya Birla Group.

India puts 14 past Indonesia in junior Asia Cup opener

India made a commanding start to its title defence at the junior men's Asia Cup at Moqi (China) with a 14-0 victory over Indonesia in Pool-A in Moqi (China) on Saturday. Captain Anmol Ekka, Prabhdeep Singh, and Ajeet Yadav scored 12 goals between them. Prabhdeep found the net five times while Anmol contributed four goals and Ajeet scored a hat-trick. Harpal and Ashu Maurya accounted for the other two strikes.

India outplays South Korea, begins title defence in style

India began its title defence in the women's junior Asia Cup hockey with a 4-1 win over South Korea at Moqi (China) on Saturday. Sanika Mane (eighth), Purnima Yadav (30th), Puja Sahoo (45th) and Madhu Sidar (51st) found the target. KIL Gabin (57th) reduced the margin.

Anahat's London Squash Classic run ends in quarters

Anahat Singh bowed out of the London Squash Classic, going down to Malaysian World No. 5 Sivasangari Subramaniam 4-11, 4-11 in the quarterfinals of the PSA Gold event.

IWL season to commence on October 16

The new season of the Indian Women's League will begin on Oct. 16 with six clubs from last year – East Bengal, Sethu, Kickstart, Nita, Gokulam Kerala and Garhwal United – joined by new sides HOPS and Juba Sangha. The group stage (Oct. 23 start) will have 20 clubs divided into four groups.

TNCA INTER-DIST. U-23

Sanjeevan's 104 eclipses Soumo Deep's 121 as Kancheepuram eases past Villupuram
S. Soumo Deep Aravind Manna hammered 121 for Villupuram but it went in vain as Kancheepuram rode on M. Sanjeevan's 104 for a four-wicket win in a Group E clash of the TNCA under-23 inter-district tournament at Dharmapuri on Saturday.
The scores:
Group E: Villupuram 264 in 47.5 overs (S. Soumo Deep Aravind Manna 121, R. Tamil Maran 43, S. Mukundhan 4/48, S. Muthukumar 3/25) lost to Kancheepuram 265/6 in 38.2 overs (M. Sanjeevan 104, A.K. Rajagopalan 67).



Sanjeevan (Kancheepuram, 104).

LIVE TELECAST

Duleep Trophy: Final, Day 1, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.
T20I tri-series: Final, FanCode, 5.30 p.m.
Premier League: SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 6.30 & 9 p.m.
Formula One: Italian GP, F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & FanCode, 6.30 p.m.
LaLiga: FanCode, 7.45, 10 p.m. & 12.30 a.m. (Monday).
Women's T20 Asia Cup: Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 8 p.m.
US Open: SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 8.30 p.m. & 4.30 a.m. (Monday).

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA league, II div., Coromandel vs. Rising Stars (Murgappal); Alwarpet vs. Jupiter (Tagore); Cromptest vs. MCC (Venkateswara); Bunts vs. India Pistons (A.M. Jain); S. Rly. vs. Komaleeswarar (S. Rly.); Egmore RC vs. Garnet (CSK-Guru Nana), 9 a.m.; V-C, State Bank vs. Dorairaj MCC (MIT); Nungambakkam SC vs. Gems (Wahe Guru-B); University Union vs. Varsity Occasionals (Union); Sridhar vs. VAP (Engg.); Shivaji vs. Venkat (GE-B, Alstom); V-D, Venkateswara vs. TVS (Jones Krish, turf); Madras Emmanuel vs. Egmore Excelsiors (St. Bede's-A); Saidapet Gymkhana vs. Eagle (Sumangali-A, turf); Youngsters vs. Universal (St. Bede's-B); Madras Indians vs. Gandhi (St. Patrick's); National CC vs. ICI (Gandhi Nagar), 9.30 a.m.
Tennis: Third RWD Open Chennai City club league-cum-knockout championship, finals, former India hockey captain and Olympian Mohammed Riaz, chief guest, SDAT Tennis Stadium, Nungambakkam, 4.30 p.m.

Proven performers take centre stage in the final showdown

Padikkal and Siraj's presence gives South the edge over East at Chepauk; however, Sooryavanshi could be the X-factor for Kishan's men; Shreyas and Shami set for their 100th First Class game

DULEEP TROPHY

S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

The Indian cricketing calendar is jam-packed with international matches, the IPL and other State-run T20 leagues in addition to multi-format domestic competitions. Nested in this congested schedule, tournaments like the Duleep Trophy, once a marquee event in which the top players took part, are fighting for relevance.

Still, the powers that be have tried to keep the legacy events alive through numerous tweaks. Back in the zonal avatar since last year, this prestigious tournament is now the curtain-raiser for the domestic season, the summit clash of which will see South Zone take on East Zone here at the MAC Stadium from Sunday.

The next five days offer proven performers from last year and some of India's top stars a chance to show their wares and fine-tune skills.

The arrival of Devdutt Padikkal and Mohammed Siraj has bolstered the Ti-



Willow-wielders: South's Karun and Jagadeesan have another chance to showcase their skills. R. RAGU

lak Varma-led South.

Padikkal, who recently scored centuries in both Tests against Sri Lanka, in which he was also the Player-of-the-Series, will look to continue his purple patch.

In contrast, Siraj looked off colour against the Islanders and needs to use this opportunity to find his rhythm again.

The red-soil pitch at the Chepauk should offer some assistance to the quick on the first few days,

and Siraj needs to make it count.

For Shreyas Gopal – who played a crucial role with the bat (87) in South's victory over North Zone in the semifinals – it will be a special occasion as he will feature in his 100th First Class appearance.

Joining him in the landmark will be Mohammed Shami, whom East will depend on to reclaim the Duleep Trophy it last won at this venue in 2012. The pacer bagged five wickets

in the semifinals against Central Zone and would want to continue his fine show as he keeps banging the door for a return to the national side.

Though Ishan Kishan's men might look like the underdog on paper, the presence of teen sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi gives the outfit an X-factor.

A Sooryavanshi special in a big game in the longest format could be the perfect appetiser for the domestic season.

Kishan, Tilak SWAT away concerns of short turnaround time

S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

Even as Ishan Kishan and Tilak Varma get ready to lead their sides in the Duleep Trophy final, the duo, alongside Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, will have an added challenge of a short turnaround time before they join the Men in Blue for a three-match T20I series against Afghanistan.

The T20 series starts on September 13 in New Delhi, leaving the trio only two days to switch formats.

The skippers admitted that while it will be a challenge, they are prepared for it.

“Sometimes it gets diffi-



At the helm: East captain Kishan and South skipper Tilak. R. RAGU

cult when you are playing a Test match, and suddenly you have to go and start hitting from ball one, and then you have to go back to your domestic team and



play a whole different role,” said Kishan here on Saturday.

“At the same time, I feel, as professionals, it's our job to adapt. We cannot be

coming up with excuses after knowing this is like your routine for the next few days.”

Meanwhile, Tilak added that the players are experienced enough to handle these scheduling quirks.

“We have played enough domestic games; we have played in every condition so that we can adjust to the conditions. We know how to change our mindsets and maintain our bodies with good fluids and everything.

“We have played back-to-back games before in the domestic as well as international [circuits], so we are quite used to it,” Tilak remarked.

Iron Mirage wins feature

HYDERABAD: Trainer Prasanna Kumar's ward Iron Mirage, piloted by Akshay Kumar, won the Y. Shanker Rao Memorial Deccan Colts Championship, the main attraction of Saturday's races here. The winner is owned by Mr. Meka Yugandhar, Capt. Jamshed J. Appoo, Mr. K. Manoj Kumar, Mr. Ashok Ranpise & Mr. D.R. Thacker rep. DT Racing & Breeders LLP. Jockey Akshay went straight down to business, taking charge from the word go and set the pace. This son of Dreamfield-Setareh travelled smoothly and on entering the straight, effortlessly extended his lead to score a comfortable victory. With this fluent success, Iron Mirage maintained his unbeaten record, completing four wins from four starts.

1. TIGER TOPS PLATE (1,200M): AOS SI (Antony Raj S) 1, Iconic Star (Rafique Sk) 2, Sugriva (Mohit) 3 and Hopewell Island (G. Naresb) 4. 1-1/4, 1/2 and 3/4. Im 16.58s. ₹17 (w), 12, 45 and 14 (p). SHP: 121, THP: 57, FP: 347, Q: 324, Tanala: 1.943. Favourite: AOS Si. Owner: Mrs. Smitta Bajoria. Trainer: A. Imran Khan.

2. MOUNT PLEASANT PLATE (1,100M): YALI (P. Trevor) 1, Bella's Touch (M.S. Deora) 2, Champden Reef (Akshay K) 3 and Sha' Carri (Neeraj) 4. 4-1/2, 2 and 1/2. Im 7.09s. ₹21 (w), 16, 31 and 10 (p). SHP: 198, THP: 50, FP: 388, Q: 259, Tanala: 571. Favourite: Yali.

3. MEGA TOPS PLATE (1,800M): PLEDGE (Antony Raj S) 1, One Nation (B.R. Kumar) 2, N R I Ultrapower (Md. Ekram) 3 and Armstrong (Kuldeep Sr.) 4. 4, 13 and 5-3/4. Im 52.38s. ₹14 (w), 11 and 15 (p). SHP: 14, THP: 25, FP: 15, Q: 11, Tanala: 22. Favourite: Pledge. Owners: M/s. Mukul A. Sonawalla, Girish Mehta, D.R. Thacker rep. DT Racing & Breeders LLP & M/s. So Blest Trading Co. Pvt. Ltd. Trainer: Darius Byramji.

4. NICE FELLA PLATE (1,400M):

LOVE ALL (R.S. Jodha) 1, Excalibur (Antony Raj) 2, Advait (Trevor) 3 and N R I Crypto Power (Akshay K) 4. 2-3/4, 2-1/2 and 2-3/4. Im 26.29s. ₹23 (w), 11, 13 and 11 (p). SHP: 32, THP: 46, FP: 59, Q: 43, Tanala: 166. Favourite: Love All. Owners: Mr. Raghunath rep. Gava Racing Syndicate LLP. Trainer: K. Satheesh.

5. ASAF JAH VII MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,600M): WOLF CREEK (Akshay Kumar) 1, Krystallos (P. Ajeeth K) 2, Lifes Journey (Ajay K) 3 and Lucky Zone (Kuldeep Jr.) 4. Neck, 1-1/2 and 1-1/4. Im 41.05s. ₹18 (w), 12, 20 and 20 (p). SHP: 67, THP: 75, FP: 50, Q: 41, Tanala: 263. Favourite: Wolf Creek. Owners: Mr. Imran Isa Sayyed, Mr. S. Saleem Shah & The Estate of Late Mr. L.D' Silva. Trainer: R.H. Sequeira.

6. Y. SHANKER RAO MEMORIAL DECCAN COLTS CHAMPIONSHIP (GR.III) (1,600M): IRON MIRAGE (Dreamfield - Setareh) (Akshay Kumar) 1, Garfunkle (Plumatic - Scarborough Fair) (Trevor) 2, Buddy (Dali - Dangal) (D.S. Deora) 3 and Asterion (Leitr Mor - Starry Eyes) (Vivek G) 4. Not run: Aprameya. 4-1/4, 3-1/4 and 1-1/2. Im 37.59s. ₹13 (w), 10, 14 and 64 (p). SHP: 43, THP: 158, FP: 53, Q: 44, Tanala: 463. Favourite: Iron Mirage.

7. HYPERION PLATE (1,200M): EQUINE POWER (P. Sai Kumar) 1, Farsiris (Akshay K) 2, Aquatone (A.A. Vikrant) 3 and Golden Aura (Abhay Singh) 4. Not run: Moonlite Rose. 3-1/2, 9 and 2. Im 14.36s. ₹15 (w), 12, 15 and 15 (p). SHP: 52, THP: 40, FP: 47, Q: 34, Tanala: 123. Favourite: Equine Power. Owners: M/s. Ashok Ranpise, D.R. Thacker, Mukund Kakani, Teja Gollapudi, Teegala Vijender Reddy, Teegala Sumant Reddy, Seshadri Reddy Pochana & Bollineni Krishnaksh. Trainer: K.S.V. Prasad Raju. Jackpot: 70% ₹214 (229 tkts.), 30%: 46 (4,561 tkts.). Mini Jackpot: (i) 163 (410 tkts.), (ii) 126 (355 tkts.). Treble: (i) 95 (353 tkts.), (ii) 45 (814 tkts.).

Paddler Swastika puts behind her medical ordeal to shine in Almaty

Amol Karhadkar
MUMBAI

Swastika Ghosh produced one of the biggest upsets of her international career before bowing out in the round of 16 at the WTT Contender in Almaty, Kazakhstan, on Thursday.

The 23-year-old Indian paddler, ranked 149th in the world, defeated second seed Miyuu Kihara of Japan, the World No. 25, 3-1 in the opening round on Wednesday. Swastika's run ended against Russia's Vlada Voronina, who beat her in straight games in Thursday's pre-quarterfinal.

“This is one of the most significant moments of my journey so far. I hope I can build on it and keep improving my game, performance and ranking,” Swastika told *The Hindu*.

The victory came after a difficult period in which a medical problem disrupted her progress. Swastika was diagnosed with an ovarian cyst in 2024 after undergoing a routine sports-medicine check-up prompted by a bleeding issue and an unusually high



Future plan: Swastika's immediate challenge will be to convert her recent form into more consistent performances.

resting heart rate.

She managed the condition and bouts of pain for nearly a year before undergoing surgery earlier this year. The procedure forced her to withdraw from the singles events at the National and also affected her Asian Games prospects.

Since returning to competition, however, Swastika has steadily rebuilt her form. She was part of India's gold-medal-winning team at the Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships in August, is the first standby for the Asian Games and reached the semifinals of the season-



Will relentless Shami get another go at the international level?

S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

When Mohammed Shami walks onto the MAC Stadium turf on Sunday for East Zone in the Duleep Trophy final against South Zone, it will be a momentous occasion for the 36-year-old, who will be featuring in his 100th First Class match.

As he aims to return to the national team, Shami has been putting in the hard yards in domestic cricket. Last year, the pacer took 37 wickets in the Ranji Trophy from seven matches as Bengal narrowly missed out on making the summit clash.

This season, in two Duleep outings so far, the veteran speedster has bowled with pace and verve, prompting East Zone skipper Ishan Kishan to praise him lavishly.

“He has been picking up wickets, giving all his energy. He is coming in and asking me for those extra overs to get the wickets.

“It is hard when you are not regularly playing for the Indian team and to have that kind of motivation for domestic games. But I see that hunger in him.

“You can see when he is trying to help me – he comes and gives options about what can be done,” Kishan added.

At a time when Jasprit Bumrah is battling injuries and Mohammed Siraj is not looking at his sharpest, another good run in domestic cricket could get Shami back in the reckoning. India's next Test tour is



Shami. FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

to New Zealand, where conditions will be seamer-friendly. Shami can also be a great asset in the 2027 ODI World Cup in South Africa, a tournament where he boasts of a stellar record – 55 wickets at a world-leading average of 13.52.

In the last Duleep game against Central Zone in Bengaluru, the way Shami set up Yash Rathod – testing the batter outside the off-stump, softening him up with a few bouncers before nipping one away to get him caught behind – showed a bowler still at the top of his game.

During that fixture, National selector Pragyan Oja had a long discussion with the pacer from Amroha. Opening of a fresh chapter in Shami's international career? Time will tell.

ISL-13 to kick off on Oct. 10 under new structure

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

The Indian Super League (ISL) will begin its 13th season on October 10 under a new club-led structure.

The competition will be returning to the home-and-away format and will feature 13 teams with 163 matches. The team finishing on top after the double-leg league will be crowned the Shield winner and will be treated as the official champion. The new season will also see the return of the playoff format. The top six teams will compete for the ISL Cup.

The 13-team field includes holder East Bengal, Mohun Bagan Super Giant, Bengaluru FC, Chennaiyin FC, Churchill Brothers, FC Goa, Inter Kashi, Kerala Blasters, Mumbai City, NorthEast United, Odisha FC, Punjab FC, and Sporting Club Delhi.

Diamond Harbour FC failed to meet the administrative fee requirement and will not take up its slot.

$\Delta \text{CH-CH}_2$



Life on slopes: Traditional stone houses cling to the rugged mountainside in Suru Valley, Kargil.



Celebration begins: Residents and visitors come together for the opening of the second Suru Summer Festival.



Woven tales: Ladakhi artisans work with wool, keeping alive a traditional craft of the region.



Beyond the everyday: Girls in headscarves peer out from a traditional woven-wood structure; during the festival, young women deck themselves in ornate silver headdresses and vibrant traditional attire for the celebrations.

Where the mountains narrate stories

Suru Valley preserves a rich cultural heritage shaped by Purgi traditions, Islamic and Buddhist influences; the Suru Summer Festival recently showcased this legacy as the administration promotes Kargil as a sustainable tourism destination



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Suru Valley, around 90 km from Kargil in Ladakh and 290 km from Srinagar in Jammu and Kashmir, is steeped in a rich and harmonious cultural heritage. Tucked away in the Himalayas, it is surrounded by glacial deposits and famous peaks. The valley is primarily inhabited by the Purgi people of Tibetan descent, representing a unique historical blend of Islamic and Buddhist traditions. While the lower valley follows Islamic traditions, the higher reaches remain deeply connected to the Buddhist heritage of neighbouring Zaskar. The locals maintain a traditional agrarian lifestyle rooted in hospitality and spiritual devotion. Isolated from heavy commercialisation, the valley preserves an authentic way of life, where centuries-old customs, local Ladakhi-Balti cuisine and communal farming practices continue to thrive undisturbed. The second Suru Summer Festival, recently

organised by the Ladakh administration, focused on promoting Kargil as a premier sustainable, cultural and adventure tourism destination, while creating greater livelihood and employment opportunities for local communities. As part of the event, various adventure activities were organised at different locations. A cycle rally, paragliding, river rafting and rock climbing were among the highlights of the festival. The Department of Tourism and Culture, local entrepreneurs, social media influencers and other stakeholders joined hands for the festival to promote the region's traditional culture, cuisine, attire and language. Suru Valley, which features in National Geographic's tourism listings, is gaining appeal among travellers while remaining a relatively unexplored destination. The administration plans to expand the festival's footprint across the broader district, including Drass and Zaskar.



Festive grace: Performers bring the region's music and cultural traditions to the festival stage.

Cooling off: A woman serves curd to visitors seeking respite from the heat under traditional woven structures.

Serving tradition: A local delicacy of cooked apricots is served to visitors during the Suru festival.

Seeking shade: A woman rests with a child inside a traditional wooden structure in Suru valley. The portable structures come handy during the festival.

Above the valley: Paragliders take to the skies; the sport was among the adventure activities organised as part of the festival to promote Kargil as an adventure tourism destination.

Echoes of culture: Locals and visitors mingle as the Suru festival brings the valley's culture and traditions into focus.